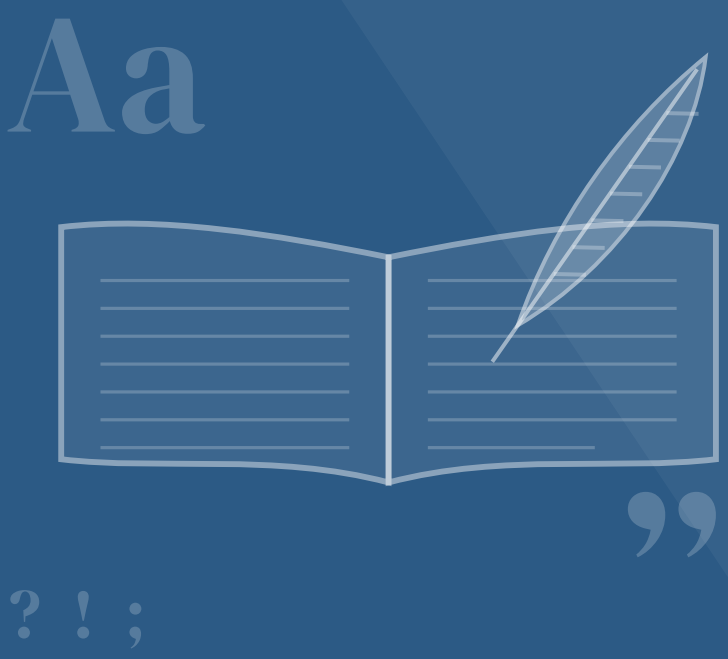
VENVLEARNING

STUDENT WORKBOOK



English Language Arts

GRADE 4

Daily practice, weekly checks, and unit tests

2026–2027 School Year · 9 units

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

GRADE 4 · ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

VENVLEARNING

Grade 4
English Language Arts

STUDENT WORKBOOK

2026–2027 School Year

Unit 1 Word Power
Unit 2 Reading Closely
Unit 3 Reading Longer Texts
Unit 4 The Writer's Craft
Unit 5 Reading Deeply
Unit 6 Sources and Evidence
Unit 7 Reading Across Texts
Unit 8 Grammar and Conventions
Unit 9 Capstone

This book belongs to _____

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this workbook

Every lesson in your textbook has matching practice pages here. Show your thinking in the work space. When a problem has an answer line, write your final answer there.

- Warm-Up reviews something you already know.
- Practice uses today's lesson.
- Think Deeper problems ask you to explain or find a mistake.
- Exit Ticket shows your teacher what you learned today.

Contents

Word Power 9

Lesson 1.1: Meet King Arthur: Reading a Legend 10
Lesson 1.2: Prefixes 12
Lesson 1.3: Suffixes 14
Lesson 1.4: Greek and Latin Roots 16
Weekly Check 1: Word Parts 18
Lesson 1.5: Context Clues: Definitions and Restatements 19
Lesson 1.6: Context Clues: Synonyms and Antonyms 22
Lesson 1.7: Context Clues: Examples and Inference 24
Lesson 1.8: Multiple-Meaning Words and the Dictionary 26
Weekly Check 2: Context Clues 28
Lesson 1.9: Similes and Metaphors 30
Lesson 1.10: Idioms, Adages, and Proverbs 32
Lesson 1.11: Shades of Meaning 34
Lesson 1.12: Academic and Content Words 36
Weekly Check 3: Figurative Language and Word Choice 38
Lesson 1.13: Strong Verbs and Vivid Adjectives 40
Lesson 1.14: Planning a Narrative: Sequence and Transitions 42
Lesson 1.15: Drafting a Narrative Scene 44
Lesson 1.16: Revising, Editing, and Publishing 46
Unit 1 Review 48

Unit 1 Test 49

Reading Closely 52

Lesson 2.1: Text Evidence: Quoting and Paraphrasing 53
Lesson 2.2: Text Evidence in Informational Text 55
Lesson 2.3: Choosing the Best Evidence 57
Lesson 2.4: Writing with Evidence: The ACE Paragraph 59
Weekly Check 4: Text Evidence 60
Lesson 2.5: Making Inferences 62
Lesson 2.6: Inferring Characters' Feelings and Motives 64
Lesson 2.7: Inferences in Informational Text 66
Lesson 2.8: Writing to Support an Inference 68
Weekly Check 5: Inference 69
Lesson 2.9: Theme in Stories 70
Lesson 2.10: How Characters Reveal Theme 72
Lesson 2.11: Main Idea and Key Details 74
Lesson 2.12: Comparing Themes Across Stories 76
Weekly Check 6: Theme and Main Idea 77
Lesson 2.13: Summarizing a Story 79
Lesson 2.14: Summarizing Informational Text 80
Lesson 2.15: How Events Develop: Cause and Effect in a Plot 81
Lesson 2.16: Writing a Summary Paragraph 83
Unit 2 Review 84
Unit 2 Test 85

Reading Longer Texts 88

Lesson 3.1: Building Reading Stamina 89
Lesson 3.2: Annotating a Text 91
Lesson 3.3: Fix-Up Strategies 93
Lesson 3.4: Narrator and Point of View 95
Weekly Check 7: Reading Longer Texts 96
Lesson 3.5: Tracking a Character Across a Text 97

Lesson 3.6: Explaining Events and Procedures . . . 98
Lesson 3.7: Connecting Evidence from Several Paragraphs . . . 100
Lesson 3.8: Writing with Evidence from Across a Text . . . 102
Weekly Check 8: Tracking Evidence . . . 103
Lesson 3.9: Inferences and Predictions . . . 104
Lesson 3.10: Inferring the Theme of a Longer Story . . . 106
Lesson 3.11: Inferring the Author's Ideas in Informational Text . . . 107
Lesson 3.12: Explaining an Inference in Writing . . . 108
Weekly Check 9: Inference . . . 109
Lesson 3.13: Understanding the Prompt . . . 111
Lesson 3.14: Planning an Organized Response . . . 113
Lesson 3.15: Drafting the Response . . . 115
Lesson 3.16: Revising for Organization . . . 117
Unit 3 Review . . . 118
Unit 3 Test . . . 119

The Writer's Craft . . . 122

Lesson 4.1: Reading Old-Fashioned Language . . . 123
Lesson 4.2: Words from Mythology . . . 125
Lesson 4.3: Sensory Language and Mood . . . 127
Lesson 4.4: Content Words in Informational Text . . . 129
Weekly Check 10: Words and Phrases . . . 131
Lesson 4.5: Poems, Drama, and Prose . . . 132
Lesson 4.6: Writing a Scene: From Story to Drama . . . 134
Lesson 4.7: Informational Text Structures . . . 136
Lesson 4.8: Text Structures and Graphic Organizers . . . 138
Weekly Check 11: Text Structure . . . 140
Lesson 4.9: Author's Purpose . . . 142
Lesson 4.10: Firsthand and Secondhand Accounts . . . 144
Lesson 4.11: Characters' Points of View . . . 145
Lesson 4.12: Facts, Opinions, and Persuasive Language . . . 146
Weekly Check 12: Purpose and Point of View . . . 147

Lesson 4.13: How Authors Build Suspense . . . 148
Lesson 4.14: Comparing Text and Illustration . . . 150
Lesson 4.15: Comparing Fiction and Nonfiction on the Same Topic . . . 152
Lesson 4.16: Writing a Comparison Paragraph . . . 154
Unit 4 Review . . . 155
Unit 4 Test . . . 156

Reading Deeply . . . 159

Lesson 5.1: Plot Structure . . . 160
Lesson 5.2: Analyzing a Character in Depth . . . 163
Lesson 5.3: How Setting Shapes a Story . . . 165
Lesson 5.4: Summarizing a Long Story . . . 166
Weekly Check 13: Plot and Character . . . 167
Lesson 5.5: Text Features . . . 169
Lesson 5.6: Reading Charts, Diagrams, and Timelines . . . 171
Lesson 5.7: Main Ideas of Sections and the Whole Text . . . 172
Lesson 5.8: Integrating Information to Explain a Topic . . . 173
Weekly Check 14: Informational Text Features . . . 174
Lesson 5.9: Comparing Story Structures . . . 176
Lesson 5.10: Comparing Narrators . . . 178
Lesson 5.11: Comparing Two Informational Texts . . . 179
Lesson 5.12: Speaking Knowledgeably from Two Texts . . . 180
Weekly Check 15: Comparing Texts . . . 181
Lesson 5.13: Comparison Essay Structure . . . 183
Lesson 5.14: Planning the Comparison Essay . . . 184
Lesson 5.15: Drafting the Comparison Essay . . . 186
Lesson 5.16: Revising and Editing the Comparison Essay . . . 188
Unit 5 Review . . . 189
Unit 5 Test . . . 190

Sources and Evidence . . . 193

Lesson 6.1: Primary and Secondary Sources . . . 194

Lesson 6.2: Comparing Sources on the Same Topic . . . 196
Lesson 6.3: Is This Source Reliable? . . . 197
Lesson 6.4: Taking Notes from Sources . . . 198
Weekly Check 16: Sources . . . 199
Lesson 6.5: Claims, Reasons, and Evidence . . . 201
Lesson 6.6: Evaluating Evidence . . . 203
Lesson 6.7: Opinion Writing: Claims and Reasons . . . 204
Lesson 6.8: Opinion Writing: Linking Words and Conclusions . . . 205
Weekly Check 17: Reasons and Evidence . . . 207
Lesson 6.9: Reading Labeled Diagrams . . . 208
Lesson 6.10: Reading Maps . . . 209
Lesson 6.11: Reading Graphs in Informational Text . . . 210
Lesson 6.12: Adding Visuals to Your Writing . . . 211
Weekly Check 18: Visual Information . . . 212
Lesson 6.13: Starting a Research Project . . . 213
Lesson 6.14: Organizing Research Notes . . . 214
Lesson 6.15: Drafting a Research Report . . . 215
Lesson 6.16: Revising and Presenting Research . . . 218
Unit 6 Review . . . 219
Unit 6 Test . . . 220

Reading Across Texts . . . 223

Lesson 7.1: Reading a Text Set with a Guiding Question . . . 224
Lesson 7.2: Annotating Across Texts . . . 225
Lesson 7.3: The Quest Pattern Across Cultures . . . 227
Lesson 7.4: Good and Evil in Traditional Stories . . . 229
Weekly Check 19: Quest Patterns . . . 230
Lesson 7.5: Myths as Explanations . . . 232
Lesson 7.6: Scientific Explanations . . . 234
Lesson 7.7: Comparing a Myth and a Scientific Explanation . . . 236
Lesson 7.8: Which Explanation Is Better? . . . 237
Weekly Check 20: Comparing Explanations . . . 238

Lesson 7.9: Integrating Details from Several Sources . . . 240
Lesson 7.10: Quoting and Citing Within Writing . . . 241
Lesson 7.11: Quote, Paraphrase, or Summarize? . . . 242
Lesson 7.12: Collaborative Discussion . . . 243
Weekly Check 21: Integrating Sources . . . 244
Lesson 7.13: Planning a Synthesis Essay . . . 246
Lesson 7.14: Drafting the Synthesis Essay . . . 247
Lesson 7.15: Revising with Peer Feedback . . . 249
Lesson 7.16: Editing and Publishing the Synthesis Essay . . . 250
Unit 7 Review . . . 251
Unit 7 Test . . . 252

Grammar and Conventions . . . 255

Lesson 8.1: Nouns: Common, Proper, and Plural . . . 256
Lesson 8.2: Possessive Nouns . . . 258
Lesson 8.3: Pronouns and Relative Pronouns . . . 260
Lesson 8.4: Agreement: Subjects, Verbs, and Pronouns . . . 262
Weekly Check 22: Nouns and Pronouns . . . 264
Lesson 8.5: Verb Tenses and Irregular Verbs . . . 265
Lesson 8.6: Progressive Tenses . . . 267
Lesson 8.7: Modal Auxiliaries . . . 268
Lesson 8.8: Complete Sentences, Fragments, and Run-Ons . . . 269
Weekly Check 23: Verbs and Sentences . . . 271
Lesson 8.9: Capitalization . . . 272
Lesson 8.10: Punctuating Dialogue . . . 273
Lesson 8.11: Commas in Compound Sentences and Lists . . . 274
Lesson 8.12: Order of Adjectives and Prepositional Phrases . . . 276
Weekly Check 24: Capitals and Punctuation . . . 278
Lesson 8.13: Frequently Confused Words . . . 279
Lesson 8.14: Spelling Patterns and Checking Spelling . . . 280
Lesson 8.15: Punctuation and Words for Effect . . . 281
Lesson 8.16: Editing a Whole Passage . . . 282

Unit 8 Review 283
Unit 8 Test 284

Capstone 286

Lesson 9.1: Vocabulary Review 287
Lesson 9.2: Comprehension Review: Literature 289
Lesson 9.3: Comprehension Review: Informational Text 291
Lesson 9.4: Strategies for Reading Tests 293
Weekly Check 25: Reading Review 294
Lesson 9.5: Building a Writing Portfolio 296
Lesson 9.6: Writing a Reflection 297
Lesson 9.7: Setting Goals 298
Lesson 9.8: Planning a Capstone Piece 299
Weekly Check 26: Portfolio and Goals 300
Lesson 9.9: Drafting and Revising for Ideas and Organization 301
Lesson 9.10: Revising for Word Choice and Sentence Variety 304
Lesson 9.11: Editing with a Checklist 305
Lesson 9.12: Publishing 306
Weekly Check 27: Revising and Editing 307
Lesson 9.13: Planning a Presentation with Evidence 308
Lesson 9.14: Visuals and Speaking Skills 309
Lesson 9.15: Practicing and Listening 310
Lesson 9.16: Presentation Day and Celebration 311
Year-End Review 312
Grade 4 ELA Year-End Test 313

UNIT 1

Word Power

Word parts, context clues, figurative language, and precise words, with King Arthur and the Round Table, Chapters 1–4.

Your practice pages for Unit 1. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

prefix	A word part at the beginning of a word.
suffix	A word part at the end of a word.
root	The main part of a word.
context clue	A hint in the text about a word's meaning.
simile	A comparison using like or as.
metaphor	A comparison saying one thing is another.
idiom	A phrase with a meaning different from its words.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.1 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.1: Meet King Arthur: Reading a Legend

Name _____ Date _____

I can describe the characters and setting of a legend and use details from the text.

Warm-Up

1 What is a setting?

2 Name a story you know that has a hero.

Read and Respond: Chapter 1

3 Who is the main character the legend is about? How do you know he will be important?

4 Describe Merlin. Use one detail from the chapter.

5 Describe the setting. Include when and where.

6 A legend is...

A a true report written by a reporter
B a story from long ago about a hero, with parts that are made up
C a poem that rhymes
D a set of directions

Think Deeper

7 Why do you think people kept telling stories about King Arthur for hundreds of years?

Exit Ticket

8 Write one sentence describing a character from Chapter 1. Include a detail from the text.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.2 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.2: Prefixes

Name _____ Date _____

I can use prefixes to figure out the meaning of new words.

Warm-Up

1. Add un- to kind. Meaning?

2. Add re- to read. Meaning?

Prefix Practice

Write the meaning of each word.

3. unsafe

4. replay

5. disagree

6. misspell

7. preview

8. nonfiction

9. disconnect

10. refill

Use the Passage

REALISTIC FICTION

The Unlucky Kite

An original story

1 Mia was unhappy. Her new kite had disappeared over the tall fence behind the library. She had misjudged the wind, and the string had slipped right out of her fingers.

2 “We can rebuild it,” said her brother Theo. “I'll reread the directions, and you can retie the tail.”

3 Mia shook her head. “It's not the same. That kite was a gift from Grandma. I disliked the old one, but I loved this one.”

4 Just then, a woman leaned over the fence. She held up a bright red kite with a crooked tail. “Is this yours?” she asked with a smile. “It landed in my tomato plants. Next time, I suggest you pretest the wind before you let out all that string!”

5 Mia's frown disappeared. This was not such an unlucky day after all.

11 Find two words with prefixes in “The Unlucky Kite.” Write each word and its meaning.

12 In paragraph 5, “Mia's frown disappeared” means her frown...

A got bigger
B went away
C came back
D was misjudged

Think Deeper

13 Is under a word with the prefix un-? Explain how you know.

Exit Ticket

14 Write a sentence using a word with the prefix re- or mis-. Underline the word.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.3 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.3: Suffixes

Name _____ Date _____

I can use suffixes to figure out the meaning and part of speech of new words.

Warm-Up

1. Add -ful to joy. Meaning?

2. Add -less to joy. Meaning?

Suffix Practice

Write the meaning of each word.

3. powerful

4. spotless

5. quietly

6. kindness

7. washable

8. teacher

9. sailor

10. thankful

Use the Passage

REALISTIC FICTION

Mr. Hollis and the Hopeless Garden

An original story

1 Everyone on Pine Street agreed that the empty lot was hopeless. It was full of broken bottles, rusty cans, and weeds taller than a fourth grader.

2 Then Mr. Hollis, a retired gardener, moved in next door. Every morning he worked slowly and carefully, pulling weeds and filling bags with trash. His neighbors thought his effort was pointless.

3 By June, though, the darkness of the old lot had given way to bright sunflowers and rows of beans. Children who had once been fearless about climbing the fence now walked gently between the rows. Mr. Hollis let anyone pick vegetables, as long as they were thankful and left the plants unharmed.

4 "Nothing is hopeless," Mr. Hollis told a reporter, "if you are willing to get your hands dirty."

11 In paragraph 1, hopeless means...

A full of hope
B without hope
C hoping again
D a person who hopes

12 Mr. Hollis said, "Nothing is hopeless." What did he mean? Use a detail from the story.

Think Deeper

13 Write a sentence that uses both careful and careless to show the difference.

Exit Ticket

14 Add a suffix to loud to tell how something was done.

15 Add a suffix to fear to mean "without fear."

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.4 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.4: Greek and Latin Roots

Name _____ Date _____

I can use Greek and Latin roots to figure out the meaning of words.

Warm-Up

1. Which root means “hear”?

2. Which root means “carry”?

Root Practice

Use the roots to write each meaning.

3. telescope

4. autograph

5. transport

6. audio

7. vision

8. export

Use the Passage

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Messages Across the Miles

An original informational text

1 Long ago, sending a message far away was slow. A rider might transport a letter on horseback for weeks. Some kingdoms used tall towers with fires on top, so that a guard could see a visible signal from one hill to the next.

2 In the 1800s, the telegraph changed everything. Electric signals traveled along wires, and an operator wrote down the message in dots and dashes. A few years later, the telephone let people hear each other's voices across many miles.

3 Today, a video call lets a grandmother in Texas see and hear her grandson in Japan at the same moment. The audience for a single online video can include millions of people. The roots of these words come from Greek and Latin, but the inventions are as modern as the phone in your pocket.

9 In paragraph 1, a visible signal is one that can be...

A heard
B carried
C seen
D written

10 Explain how the telephone was different from the telegraph. Use the word roots to help.

Think Deeper

11 Invent a new word using two roots from the chart. Tell what it would mean.

Writing Connection

12 Write 3–4 sentences about how you like to send messages to family or friends. Use at least two words with roots, prefixes, or suffixes from this week. Underline them.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Oct 16 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 1: Word Parts

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

REALISTIC FICTION

The Unbreakable Promise

An original story

1 Ava was careless with her library books. She had misplaced two of them, and the librarian, Mr. Chen, was displeased.

2 "I will repay you for them," Ava promised. "I'll use the money I earn walking dogs."

3 For three weeks, Ava walked dogs every afternoon, rain or shine. When she finally handed Mr. Chen the money, he smiled. "That was a thoughtful thing to do. Your promise was unbreakable."

1. careless means...

2. misplaced means...

3. displeased means...

4. repay means...

5. thoughtful means...

6. unbreakable means...

7. The root port in portable means...

A see
B carry
C hear
D write

8. Why did Mr. Chen say Ava's promise was unbreakable? Use a detail.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.5 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.5: Context Clues: Definitions and Restatements

Name _____ Date _____

I can use definition and restatement clues to figure out new words.

Warm-Up

1. What is context?

2. Name one signal for a definition clue.

Find the Clue

3. The castle had a portcullis, a heavy iron gate that slid down to block the entrance. What is a portcullis?

4. The squire polished the hauberk (a shirt made of small metal rings) until it shone. What is a hauberk?

5. The jester, or clown, made the king laugh. What is a jester?

6. They stored grain in the granary — the building where grain is kept. What is a granary?

Use the Passage

HISTORICAL FICTION

The Blacksmith's Apprentice

An original story

1 When Tom turned ten, his father sent him to be an apprentice, a young worker who learns a trade by helping a master. His master was Old Rowan, the village blacksmith.

2 The smithy was always hot. In the middle of the room stood the forge, a fireplace where metal is heated until it glows. Tom's first job was to pump the bellows. Each time he squeezed the leather bag, it pushed a gust of air into the fire, and the coals blazed orange.

3 Rowan held glowing iron on the anvil and pounded it with his hammer. Sparks flew like tiny stars. Unlike the soft, bendable iron that came out of the fire, the finished horseshoe was rigid after it cooled in a bucket of water.

4 At the end of the first week, Tom's arms ached and his face was smudged with soot. But when a knight's horse trotted away on shoes Tom had helped make, he felt as proud as a king.

7 In paragraph 3, what is an anvil?

A a hammer
B a heavy block where metal is pounded
C a bucket of water
D a horse

8 How did Tom feel at the end of the first week? Use a detail.

Chapter 2 Connection

9 Find one word in Chapter 2 that you didn't know. Write the sentence, the clue, and what you think the word means.

Exit Ticket

10 Write a sentence that defines the word moat using a definition clue.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.6 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.6: Context Clues: Synonyms and Antonyms

Name _____ Date _____

I can use synonym and antonym clues to figure out new words.

Warm-Up

1 A synonym for happy

2 An antonym for happy

Synonym or Antonym Clue?

3 The puppy was timid, but the older dog was bold. What does timid mean? What type of clue?

4 The path was treacherous; it was dangerous and slippery. What does treacherous mean? What type of clue?

5 Unlike his tidy sister, Max kept a messy room. What does tidy mean? What type of clue?

6 The feast was lavish. It was rich and grand, with forty dishes. What does lavish mean?

Use the Passage

HISTORICAL FICTION

Two Brothers, Two Knights

An original story

1 Sir Gareth and Sir Gaheris were brothers, but they were as different as night and day. Gareth was boisterous. He laughed loudly, sang at dinner, and told jokes that echoed through the great hall. Gaheris, on the other hand, was quiet and thoughtful.

2 Gareth was also impulsive. He jumped into adventures without thinking. Gaheris was cautious; he studied every map and asked every question before he rode out.

3 Yet the brothers agreed on one thing: a knight must be gallant, or brave and polite, to everyone, from the queen to the poorest farmer.

7 Which words in paragraph 1 signal an antonym clue for boisterous?

A as different as night and day
B on the other hand
C told jokes
D the great hall

8 Which brother would you rather go on a quest with? Use two details from the passage.

Think Deeper

9 Write a sentence that uses an antonym clue to explain the word ancient.

Exit Ticket

10 Synonym for gallant

11 Antonym for cautious

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.7 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.7: Context Clues: Examples and Inference

Name _____ Date _____

I can use example clues and the whole passage to infer word meanings.

Warm-Up

1. Signal words for example clues

2. What does infer mean?

Use the Clues

3. Knights carried many weapons, such as swords, lances, and maces. What are weapons?

4. The peddler sold wares including pots, ribbons, and spoons. What are wares?

5. After walking all day in the hot sun without water, the travelers were parched. What does parched mean?

6. The jubilant crowd cheered, sang, and danced in the streets after the victory. What does jubilant mean?

Chapter 2 Connection

7. In Chapter 2, how did people react when Arthur pulled the sword from the stone? What does that show?

Exit Ticket

8 Write a sentence with an example clue for the word instruments.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.8 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.8: Multiple-Meaning Words and the Dictionary

Name _____ Date _____

I can use context to choose the right meaning of a multiple-meaning word and check it in a dictionary.

Warm-Up

1. Two meanings of bark

2. Two meanings of ring

Which Meaning?

3. "The queen wore a crown on her head." Head means...

   A the top part of the body
   B the leader of a group
   C to go toward

4. "The team will head home after the game." Head means...

   A the top part of the body
   B the leader of a group
   C to go toward

5. "Leo won a fair game of ring toss." Fair means...

   A a festival with rides
   B honest, following the rules
   C light in color

6. "The knight's mail clanked as he walked." Mail means...

   A letters and packages
   B armor made of metal rings
   C to send

Guide Words

7. Guide words kettle – knot. Is knight on the page?

8. Guide words sail – salt. Is sword on the page?

9. Guide words castle – cave. Is cat on the page?

10. Guide words lance – large. Is lake on the page?

Exit Ticket

11 Write two sentences that use spring with two different meanings.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Oct 23 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 2: Context Clues

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

HISTORICAL FICTION

The Falconer

An original story

1 Lady Elaine was the castle's falconer. Like a teacher for birds, she trained falcons to hunt and return to her glove.

2 Training a falcon took great patience. Elaine waited for hours, never hurrying, until the young bird trusted her.

3 Her best falcon, Swift, was docile with Elaine but wild with strangers. When anyone else came near, Swift screeched and flapped its wings.

4 One day Swift soared so high it was barely visible, just a speck in the clouds. Then it plummeted, dropping straight down like a stone, and landed gently on Elaine's glove.

1. What is a falconer? Which type of clue helps?

A a bird; example clue
B a person who trains falcons; definition clue
C a castle; antonym clue

2. What does patience mean? Which words helped?

3. Docile means...

A wild
B calm and gentle
C fast

4. What does plummeted mean? What clue helped?

5 “Elaine waited for the falcon to land.” Which meaning of land fits?

A the ground of a country
B come down to rest
C to get a job

6 Guide words fall – far. Is falcon on the page?

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.9 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.9: Similes and Metaphors

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain the meaning of similes and metaphors in a text.

Warm-Up

1. Which word signals a simile?

2. Does a metaphor use like?

Simile or Metaphor? What does it mean?

3. "The classroom was a zoo."

4. "Her smile was as bright as the sun."

5. "The snow was a white blanket on the field."

6. "He ran like the wind."

Use the Passage

HISTORICAL FICTION

Storm over the Moor

An original story

1 The sky over the moor turned as dark as an iron pot. Wind howled like a hungry wolf, and the tall grass bent low to the ground.

2 Sir Bedivere pulled his cloak tighter. His horse was a statue, refusing to take another step. Rain fell in silver sheets, stinging his face like a hundred tiny needles.

3 At last, a light appeared in the distance. The little cottage was a lighthouse in a sea of storm. Bedivere's heart, cold as a stone a moment before, warmed with hope.

7 Explain the simile “rain … stinging his face like a hundred tiny needles.”

8 How do Bedivere's feelings change at the end? Which comparison shows it?

Exit Ticket

9 Write one simile and one metaphor about a knight's sword.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.10 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.10: Idioms, Adages, and Proverbs

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain the meaning of common idioms, adages, and proverbs.

Warm-Up

1 Is "break a leg" literal?

2 Name an idiom you know.

Match the Meaning

3 "A piece of cake" means...

A a dessert
B something very easy
C a small amount

4 "Look before you leap" means...

A think before you act
B jump high
C watch where you walk

5 "Under the weather" means...

A outside in rain
B feeling sick
C below the clouds

6 "The early bird catches the worm" means...

A birds eat worms
B people who start early succeed
C wake up birds

Use the Passage

PERSONAL NARRATIVE

Grandpa's Sayings

An original personal narrative

1 My grandpa has a saying for everything. When I complained about cleaning my room, he said, "Many hands make light work," and then he helped me fold my clothes.

2 When my sister was nervous about her piano recital, he told her to “break a leg.” She looked worried until Mom explained that it means “good luck.”

3 Last week, I wanted to quit soccer after we lost three games in a row. Grandpa put his hand on my shoulder. “Rome wasn't built in a day,” he said. “Keep practicing.”

4 I used to think his sayings were silly. Now, whenever I'm about to give up, I can almost hear him say, “Hang in there, kiddo.”

7 Which saying from Grandpa would you use to encourage a friend who is struggling with math? Explain why.

Exit Ticket

8 Draw or describe the literal picture of “raining cats and dogs.” Then write what it really means.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.11 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.11: Shades of Meaning

Name _____ Date _____

I can choose among words with similar meanings to say exactly what I mean.

Warm-Up

1. Synonym for small

2. Antonym for small

Order the Words

Write from weakest to strongest.

3. hot, warm, scorching

4. giggle, chuckle, howl (laughs)

5. drizzle, downpour, shower

6. tired, exhausted, sleepy

Choose the Best Word

7. Sir Kay ___ into the hall, angry that he had lost the joust.
   A stomped
   B strolled
   C tiptoed

8. The tiny kitten ___ softly from the box.
   A roared
   B mewed
   C shouted

9. After the long journey, the travelers were ___.
   A exhausted
   B awake
   C sleepy

Exit Ticket

10 Rewrite this sentence with more precise words: “The good knight went to the big castle.”

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.12 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.12: Academic and Content Words

Name _____ Date _____

I can learn and use words about a topic (content words) and words used in school (academic words).

Warm-Up

1 What does describe ask?

2 What does explain ask?

Content Words

3 moat

4 drawbridge

5 battlements

6 keep

Use the Passage

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

How a Castle Kept People Safe

An original informational text

1 During the Middle Ages, lords built castles to protect their land and people. Many castles were surrounded by a moat, a deep ditch often filled with water.

2 To enter, visitors crossed a drawbridge, a bridge that could be raised to block the gate. The tops of the thick walls had battlements, which were walls with gaps that let archers shoot while staying protected.

3 The strongest part of the castle was the keep, a tall tower where the lord's family lived. If enemies broke through the outer walls, everyone could retreat to the keep.

7 Compare a moat and a drawbridge. How were they alike? How were they different?

8 Explain why everyone retreated to the keep if enemies broke through.

Chapter 3 Connection

9 Describe the Lady of the Lake and what she gave Arthur. Use one content word from the chapter.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Oct 30 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 3: Figurative Language and Word Choice

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

PERSONAL NARRATIVE

Snow Day

An original personal narrative

1 When I woke up, the world outside my window was a giant white blanket. Snowflakes danced like tiny ballerinas past the glass.

2 My little brother was a rocket, zooming down the stairs to find his boots. “It's raining cats and dogs!” he shouted. “Snow cats and snow dogs!”

3 We built a snowman as tall as Dad. By lunchtime, my fingers were icicles, but I had never felt happier.

1. “The world outside my window was a giant white blanket.” Simile or metaphor? What does it mean?

2. Find a simile in paragraph 1 and explain it.

3. What does “It's raining cats and dogs” usually mean? Why is the brother's use of it funny?

4. “My fingers were icicles.” What does this metaphor mean?

5 Which word is strongest?

A chilly
B cool
C freezing

6 What does “Look before you leap” mean?

A Watch where you jump
B Think before you act
C Look at the snow

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.13 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.13: Strong Verbs and Vivid Adjectives

Name _____ Date _____

I can choose strong verbs and vivid adjectives to make my writing come alive.

Warm-Up

1. Is gleaming a verb or adjective here: "a gleaming sword"?

2. Verb in "Arthur drew the sword."

Revise

Rewrite each sentence with a strong verb and a vivid adjective.

3. "The horse went fast."

4. "The castle was big."

5. "The girl said she was happy."

6. "The fire was nice."

Chapter 4 Connection

7 Copy two strong verbs or vivid adjectives from Chapter 4. Explain what each helps you picture.

Exit Ticket

8 Write one sentence about a knight using a strong verb and a vivid adjective. Underline them.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.14 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.14: Planning a Narrative: Sequence and Transitions

Name _____ Date _____

I can plan a story with a clear beginning, middle, and end, using transition words.

Warm-Up

1. A transition word for the end

2. What is a sequence?

Order the Events

3. Number these events in order and add a transition word to each: ___ the knight crossed the river. ___ he saw the dragon's cave. ___ he set out from the castle. ___ he returned home a hero.

Plan Your Story

4. Your story is about a young person in King Arthur's time who faces a challenge. Beginning (character, setting, problem):

5. Middle (two or three events):

6 End (solution):

7 List five strong words you plan to use:

Exit Ticket

8 Write the first sentence of your story. Introduce the character and setting.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.15 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.15: Drafting a Narrative Scene

Name _____ Date _____

I can draft a narrative that uses dialogue, description, and precise words.

Warm-Up

1. Punctuate: Stop shouted Kay

2. When do you start a new paragraph in dialogue?

Show, Don't Tell

3. Tell: The squire was tired. Show it:

4. Tell: The feast was delicious. Show it:

5. Tell: The knight was brave. Show it:

Draft Your Story

6 Use your plan from Lesson 1.14. Write your story. Include dialogue, at least three strong words, and transitions.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.16 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.16: Revising, Editing, and Publishing

Name _____ Date _____

I can revise my writing for word choice and edit for capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Warm-Up

1. Edit: arthur pulled the sword

2. Revise: The sword was nice.

Edit These Sentences

3. merlin was a wise wizard

4. where is excalibur asked the king

5. the knights rode to camelot

6. arthur was brave he was kind

Revise and Edit Your Story

7. Use both checklists on your draft. List two revisions you made.

8. List two edits you made.

9 Publish: copy your final story neatly on separate paper or type it. Then write one sentence about what you are proudest of.

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Nov 5 (homework) or as needed · ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Unit 1 Review

Name _____ Date _____

Word parts

1. unfriendly

2. reheat

3. powerless

4. visitor

5. audible

6. telescope

Context and meaning

7. The sentry, a soldier who stood guard, watched the gate all night. What is a sentry? What kind of clue?

8. Unlike the dull knife, the new sword was sharp. What does dull mean?

9. “Her voice was music to my ears.” What does this mean?

10. Rewrite with precise words: “The man walked into the room and said hello.”

UNIT TEST · Fri Nov 6 · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Unit 1 Test

Name _____ Date _____

Show your work. This test has 18 points.

Part A · Vocabulary in context (1 point each)

HISTORICAL FICTION

The Squire's First Tournament

An original story

1 Will had been a squire, a knight's helper in training, for only one month when Sir Owen entered the great tournament. Will's job was to keep Sir Owen's armor polished and his horse ready. He was nervous; he didn't want to be careless and disappoint his master.

2 On the morning of the tournament, the field was a sea of colorful tents. Banners snapped in the wind like flags on a ship. Hundreds of people crowded the stands, cheering and waving.

3 Will checked every buckle twice. Then he noticed something terrible: a strap on Sir Owen's saddle was frayed, its threads worn and coming apart. If it broke during the joust, Sir Owen could fall.

4 Will didn't hesitate. He ran to the saddle maker's tent and returned with a new strap just as the trumpets sounded. His hands were shaking, but he replaced the strap quickly and carefully.

5 Sir Owen won his first match. Afterward, he clapped Will on the shoulder. “A knight is only as good as his squire,” he said. “Today, you were my hero.” Will's face glowed like the sunrise.

1 In paragraph 1, a squire is…

A a knight
B a knight's helper in training
C a horse

2 Which type of context clue helps you with squire?

A definition (after a comma)
B antonym
C example

3 What does frayed mean in paragraph 3? What clue helped?

4 In paragraph 1, careless means…

A full of care
B without care
C able to care

5 In paragraph 4, the word replaced has the prefix re-. It means…

A placed wrongly
B put a new one in place of the old
C placed before

6 In paragraph 4, hesitate means…

A to stop and wait before acting
B to run fast
C to shout

Part B · Figurative language (1 point each)

7 “The field was a sea of colorful tents.” Simile or metaphor? Meaning?

8 “Banners snapped in the wind like flags on a ship.” Simile or metaphor?

9 “Will's face glowed like the sunrise.” What does this show about how Will felt?

10 What does Sir Owen mean by “A knight is only as good as his squire”?

Part C · Word study (1 point each)

11 disappoint (prefix + meaning)

12 quickly (suffix + meaning)

13 audience (root + meaning)

14 Stronger word for happy

Part D · Writing (4 points)

15 Write a short scene (5–7 sentences) about what happens after the tournament. Use dialogue, a transition word, a simile or metaphor, and at least two precise words.

UNIT 2

Reading Closely

Text evidence, inference, theme and main idea, and summary, with King Arthur and the Round Table, Chapters 5–8.

Your practice pages for Unit 2. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

text evidence	Details from a text that support an answer.
inference	Clues + what I know.
theme	A story's life lesson.
main idea	The most important point of an informational text.
summary	A short retelling of the most important parts.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.1 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.1: Text Evidence: Quoting and Paraphrasing

Name _____ Date _____

I can support my answers by quoting or paraphrasing the text.

Warm-Up

1. What is text evidence?

2. What punctuation does a quote need?

Quote or Paraphrase?

3. "The table could seat many knights."

4. The author says lots of knights could sit there.

5. Arthur wanted his knights to be equal.

6. "No seat was higher than another."

Read and Respond: Chapter 5

7. Why was the Round Table important? Support your answer with a paraphrase from Chapter 5.

8. Copy one sentence from Chapter 5 that tells something about Guinevere or the wedding. Use quotation marks.

Exit Ticket

9 Paraphrase this sentence: “The knight rode swiftly through the dark forest, afraid of what waited ahead.”

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.2 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.2: Text Evidence in Informational Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can find details in an informational text that answer a question.

Warm-Up

1 Is the passage fiction or informational?

2 What is a detail?

Find the Evidence

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

The Code of Chivalry

An original informational text

1 In the Middle Ages, knights were expected to follow a set of rules called the code of chivalry. The code told knights how to behave in battle and in everyday life.

2 First, a knight was supposed to be loyal. He promised to serve his lord and protect the people who lived on his lord's land. Breaking that promise was one of the worst things a knight could do.

3 Second, a knight was expected to be brave. He had to face danger instead of running away, even when he was afraid.

4 Third, a knight was supposed to show courtesy, or good manners. He was to be polite to everyone and to protect people who could not protect themselves, such as children and the poor.

5 Not every knight followed the code. Some were greedy or cruel. Still, the code of chivalry gave people an idea of what a good knight should be, and that idea lives on in stories such as the legends of King Arthur.

3 According to paragraph 2, what was one of the worst things a knight could do?

4 What did bravery mean for a knight? Quote the text.

5 Which sentence BEST supports the idea that the code still matters today?

A "Some were greedy or cruel."
B "That idea lives on in stories such as the legends of King Arthur."
C "First, a knight was supposed to be loyal."

Think Deeper

6 Which rule of chivalry do you think is most important today? Use evidence from the passage and your own reasons.

Exit Ticket

7 Which knight in Chapter 5 shows one part of the code? Give one detail.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.3 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.3: Choosing the Best Evidence

Name _____ Date _____

I can choose the evidence that best supports an answer.

Warm-Up

1 What does relevant mean?

2 Is every true detail strong evidence?

Strongest Evidence

3 Claim: The knights in the code of chivalry were expected to be polite. Strongest evidence:

A "Knights were expected to follow a set of rules."
B "He was to be polite to everyone."
C "Breaking that promise was one of the worst things."

4 Claim: Honeybees work together in winter. Strongest evidence:

A "Many insects die or sleep through the winter."
B "The bees take turns moving from the cold outside of the cluster to the warm center."
C "A strong hive may eat 50 pounds of honey."

5 Claim: Mira grows more confident during the recital. Strongest evidence:

A "Her fingers trembled."
B "By the last chord, Mira was smiling."
C "Mira sat on the edge of her chair."

Your Evidence

6 Claim: Arthur is a good king. Write the strongest piece of evidence you can find in Chapter 5, and explain why it is strong.

Exit Ticket

7 Explain the difference between true evidence and strong evidence.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.4 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.4: Writing with Evidence: The ACE Paragraph

Name _____ Date _____

I can write a paragraph that answers a question and supports it with evidence.

Warm-Up

1. A in ACE

2. E in ACE

Label the Parts

3. Label each sentence A, C, or E: (1) "This shows Mira was scared at first." (2) "Mira was nervous before she played." (3) "Her fingers trembled above the keys."

Write an ACE Paragraph

4. How did the Round Table show that Arthur wanted his knights to be equal? Write an ACE paragraph using Chapter 5.

Exit Ticket

5. Check your paragraph. Underline your Answer, put a box around your Citation, and circle your Explanation.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Nov 13 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 4: Text Evidence

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Pigeons with a Job

An original informational text

1 For thousands of years, people have used homing pigeons to carry messages. A homing pigeon can find its way back to its home from hundreds of miles away.

2 During wars, pigeons carried notes when other ways of sending messages did not work. One famous pigeon, Cher Ami, delivered a message in 1918 that helped save almost 200 soldiers, even though she had been injured.

3 Scientists are still not completely sure how pigeons find their way. Some think the birds use the sun. Others think they can sense the earth's magnetic field, like a built-in compass.

1 What is a homing pigeon able to do? Quote the text.

2 Paraphrase what Cher Ami did.

3 Which detail BEST supports the idea that pigeons were important in wars?

A "Some think the birds use the sun."
B "Cher Ami delivered a message in 1918 that helped save almost 200 soldiers."
C "People have used homing pigeons for thousands of years."

4 Write an ACE answer: Are scientists sure how pigeons find their way?

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.5 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.5: Making Inferences

Name _____ Date _____

I can make an inference by combining text clues with what I already know.

Warm-Up

1 Text clues + ___ = inference

2 Is an inference a wild guess?

Infer

3 Sam yawned, rubbed his eyes, and put his head on his desk. How does Sam feel?

4 The crowd groaned when the ball rolled out of bounds. How did the crowd feel?

5 Lena put on her coat, hat, and two pairs of mittens before going out. What is the weather like?

Use the Passage

REALISTIC FICTION

The Missing Bread

An original story

1 When Grandma came into the kitchen, the loaf of bread she had left cooling on the counter was gone. Only a few crumbs were left on the plate.

2 She looked around. The back door was open a crack. On the floor, a trail of tiny crumbs led toward it. Next to the door was a muddy paw print, about the size of a coin.

3 Grandma followed the trail outside. Under the porch, she heard a soft crunching sound. She knelt down and peeked. Two shiny eyes blinked back at her, and a fluffy striped tail swished.

4 Grandma laughed. “Well,” she said, “I guess I'll be baking another loaf.”

6 Find two clues that the thief was small. What do they tell you?

Exit Ticket

7 Make one inference about Lancelot from Chapter 6. Write the clue that supports it.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.6 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.6: Inferring Characters' Feelings and Motives

Name _____ Date _____

I can infer how characters feel and why they act as they do, using their words and actions.

Warm-Up

1 What is a motive?

2 Name a character trait.

Infer Feelings and Traits

REALISTIC FICTION

Mira's Recital

An original story

1 Mira sat on the edge of her chair backstage, twisting the hem of her dress. Every few seconds she peeked through the curtain at the rows of people. Her stomach felt like it was full of butterflies.

2 When her name was called, she walked slowly to the piano. Her fingers trembled above the keys. She took a deep breath, closed her eyes for a moment, and began to play.

3 The first notes were shaky, but soon the music flowed. By the last chord, Mira was smiling. When the audience clapped, she bowed so low her braid almost touched the floor.

4 Backstage, her teacher hugged her. “I knew you could do it,” he said. Mira grinned. “Can I play two songs next year?”

3 How does Mira feel in paragraph 1? Give two clues.

4 How do Mira's feelings change from beginning to end? Use evidence.

5 Why does Mira ask to play two songs next year?

A She was forced to play.

B She enjoyed performing and feels confident.

C She forgot a song.

Chapter 6 Connection

6 What is one of Lancelot's character traits? What does he do or say that shows it?

Exit Ticket

7 What is one motive Lancelot has for something he does in Chapter 6?

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.7 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.7: Inferences in Informational Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can make inferences from facts in an informational text.

Warm-Up

1 What does conclude mean?

2 Do informational texts need inferences?

Connect the Facts

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Honeybees in Winter

An original informational text

1 Many insects die or sleep through the winter, but honeybees stay busy. When the weather turns cold, the bees gather in a tight ball inside their hive called a winter cluster.

2 Bees in the center of the cluster shiver their wing muscles without flapping their wings. This shivering makes heat. The bees take turns moving from the cold outside of the cluster to the warm center.

3 All winter, the bees eat honey they stored during the summer. A strong hive may eat 50 pounds of honey before spring. Beekeepers who take too much honey in the fall may find an empty hive when the flowers bloom again.

3 Paragraph 2 says the bees shiver to make heat. Why don't they flap their wings?

4 What can you infer about what happens to a hive that is very small in winter?

5 Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A Bees hate winter.

B Teamwork helps honeybees survive the cold.

C Beekeepers should take all the honey.

Exit Ticket

6 Write one fact from the passage and one inference you can make from it.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.8 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.8: Writing to Support an Inference

Name _____ Date _____

I can write a paragraph that states an inference and supports it with clues.

Warm-Up

1 Clue + know = ?

2 ACE: C =

Write an Inference Paragraph

3 What does Lancelot want most in Chapter 6? Write an ACE paragraph with at least two clues from the chapter.

Exit Ticket

4 Swap paragraphs with a family member. Write one thing they did well.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Nov 20 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 5: Inference

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

REALISTIC FICTION

The New Kid

An original story

1 Jamal stood at the edge of the playground, his hands stuffed in his pockets. He watched a group of kids playing soccer. Every time the ball rolled near him, he took a step forward, then stopped.

2 A girl with a ponytail jogged over. “We need one more player,” she said. “Want to be on my team?”

3 Jamal's face lit up. He pulled his hands out of his pockets and ran onto the field so fast he almost tripped.

1. How does Jamal feel in paragraph 1? Give two clues.

2. What does Jamal want? How do you know?

3. How does Jamal feel at the end? Clue?

4. What can you infer about the girl with the ponytail?

A She is unkind.
B She is friendly and welcoming.
C She doesn't like soccer.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.9 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.9: Theme in Stories

Name _____ Date _____

I can determine the theme of a story from the characters' actions and what they learn.

Warm-Up

1 Topic or theme? "friendship"

2 Topic or theme? "True friends help each other."

Use the Fable

FABLE

The Grasshopper and the Ants

An original retelling of an Aesop fable

1 All summer long, a grasshopper played his fiddle in the warm grass. Nearby, a line of ants marched back and forth, carrying seeds to their nest.

2 "Why work so hard?" laughed the grasshopper. "Come and sing with me! There is plenty of food everywhere."

3 "We are storing food for the winter," said one ant, never putting down her seed. "You should do the same."

4 The grasshopper only played louder. Then winter came. Snow covered the grass, and the grasshopper could find nothing to eat. Shivering and hungry, he knocked at the ants' door.

5 The ants shared a little food with him, and the grasshopper said, "Next summer, I will play and work."

3 How do the ants and the grasshopper act differently in summer? Use evidence.

4 What does the grasshopper's last line show he learned?

5 Which is the best theme statement?

A Grasshoppers play music.
B It is wise to prepare for the future.
C Winter is cold.

Exit Ticket

6 What might be a theme of Chapter 7? Give one event that supports it.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.10 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.10: How Characters Reveal Theme

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how a character's choices and changes reveal the theme.

Warm-Up

1 What is a conflict?

2 What is a resolution?

Use the Story

REALISTIC FICTION

The Two Gardens

An original story

1 Ruby and her neighbor Sam each planted a garden in the spring. Sam bought the biggest plants at the store and put them in the ground all at once. Ruby planted tiny seeds and watered them every morning.

2 In May, Sam's garden looked wonderful, and Ruby's looked like a patch of dirt. Sam teased her. “Your garden is invisible!”

3 But Sam forgot to water. By July, his plants were brown and drooping. Meanwhile, Ruby's seeds had grown into tall tomato vines and bright zinnias.

4 In August, Ruby brought Sam a basket of tomatoes. “Maybe next year,” he said with an embarrassed smile, “you can teach me how to garden.”

3 What does Ruby do differently from Sam? Give two details.

4 Why does Ruby bring Sam tomatoes instead of teasing him back? What does this show?

5 Write the theme of “The Two Gardens” and explain how Sam's change shows it.

Exit Ticket

6 How does a choice made by a character in Chapter 7 connect to a lesson?

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.11 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.11: Main Idea and Key Details

Name _____ Date _____

I can determine the main idea of an informational text and explain how key details support it.

Warm-Up

1 What is a main idea?

2 What do key details do?

Use the Passage

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Why Leaves Change Color

An original informational text

1 Every fall, trees in many parts of the country turn red, orange, and gold. The colors are not new. Many of them were inside the leaves all along.

2 During spring and summer, leaves are full of a green chemical called chlorophyll. Chlorophyll helps the tree use sunlight to make food. There is so much of it that it hides the other colors.

3 When days get shorter and cooler, the tree stops making chlorophyll. As the green fades, yellow and orange colors that were hidden begin to show. Some trees, like maples, also make new red colors in the fall.

4 Finally, the leaves dry up and fall. The tree rests through the winter and grows new green leaves in the spring.

3 Which sentence BEST states the main idea?

A Trees rest in winter.
B Leaves change color because chlorophyll fades and other colors show.
C Chlorophyll is green.

4 List two key details that support the main idea.

5 Find the main idea of “Honeybees in Winter” (Lesson 2.7).

Exit Ticket

6 What is the difference between a theme and a main idea?

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.12 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.12: Comparing Themes Across Stories

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare how two stories share or differ in theme.

Warm-Up

1 Compare =

2 Contrast =

Compare

3 Compare the theme of Chapter 7 (Sir Tristram) with "The Two Gardens." Are they alike or different? Explain with one event from each.

Venn Diagram

4 List two ways the grasshopper and Sam are alike and one way they are different.

Exit Ticket

5 Write a theme that could fit both fables you read this week.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Dec 4 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 6: Theme and Main Idea

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

FABLE

The Lion and the Mouse

An original retelling of an Aesop fable

1 A tiny mouse ran across a sleeping lion's paw. The lion woke and trapped the mouse. “Please let me go,” squeaked the mouse. “Someday I may help you.” The lion laughed at the idea, but he let the mouse go.

2 Weeks later, the lion was caught in a hunter's net. He roared, but he could not get free. The mouse heard him, ran over, and chewed through the ropes until the lion was free.

3 “You laughed at me,” said the mouse, “but even a little friend can be a big help.”

1. Why does the lion let the mouse go?

A He is scared of the mouse.
B He finds the mouse's promise funny but is kind enough to release it.
C The mouse bites him.

2. How does the mouse help the lion?

3. Write the theme of the fable as a sentence.

4. How does the lion's change show the theme?

5 Which is a TOPIC, not a theme?

A kindness

B Kindness is often returned.

C Never judge someone by size.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.13 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.13: Summarizing a Story

Name _____ Date _____

I can summarize a story using the most important events.

Warm-Up

1 SWBST: S =

2 Is a summary long?

Summarize

3 Use SWBST to summarize "Mira's Recital" (Lesson 2.6).

4 Use SWBST to summarize Chapter 8.

Exit Ticket

5 Cross out the detail that does NOT belong in a summary of the lighthouse story: (a) Nell lit the lamp. (b) The stairs were winding. (c) The boat turned in time.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.14 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.14: Summarizing Informational Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can summarize an informational text using the main idea and key details.

Warm-Up

1. Does an informational summary use SWBST?

2. What comes first in an informational summary?

Summarize

3. Summarize "Why Leaves Change Color" (Lesson 2.11) in 2–3 sentences.

4. Summarize "The Code of Chivalry" (Lesson 2.2) in 2–3 sentences.

Exit Ticket

5. What two things must an informational summary include?

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.15 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.15: How Events Develop: Cause and Effect in a Plot

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how one event in a story leads to another.

Warm-Up

1 What is a cause?

2 What is an effect?

Cause and Effect

3 Cause: The grasshopper played all summer. Effect?

4 Cause: Sam forgot to water. Effect?

5 Cause: Mira practiced and stayed brave. Effect?

6 Cause: The ants stored seeds. Effect?

Chapter 8

7 Explain how one event in Chapter 8 leads to another. Use a signal word.

Exit Ticket

8 Write a two-sentence cause-and-effect chain about your morning.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.16 · PRACTICE

Lesson 2.16: Writing a Summary Paragraph

Name _____ Date _____

I can write a well-organized summary paragraph and review the unit.

Warm-Up

1. What is a topic sentence?

2. Last sentence is the ___ sentence.

Write

3. Write a summary paragraph of Chapters 5–8 of King Arthur and the Round Table. Use a topic sentence, transitions, and a concluding sentence.

Exit Ticket

4. Which skill from this unit (evidence, inference, theme, summary) is easiest for you? Which needs practice?

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Dec 10 (homework) or as needed · ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Unit 2 Review

Name _____ Date _____

Skills

1. Quote or paraphrase: “The night was dark.”

2. Inference formula

3. Theme or topic: “courage”

4. SWBST stands for

5. Main idea is for ___ text.

6. ACE stands for

Apply

7. Reread “Honeybees in Winter.” Write its main idea and two key details.

8. Reread “The Two Gardens.” Summarize it in 2–3 sentences.

UNIT TEST · Fri Dec 11 · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Unit 2 Test

Name _____ Date _____

Show your work. This test has 14 points.

Part A · Evidence and inference (1 point each)

HISTORICAL FICTION

The Bridge at Millbrook

An original story

1 The old wooden bridge at Millbrook had stood for a hundred years. Every morning, farmers drove their wagons across it to sell vegetables in town, and children ran across it on their way to school.

2 One spring, after a week of heavy rain, the river rose higher than anyone could remember. Muddy water crashed against the bridge's legs. Ten-year-old Ada noticed that the middle of the bridge was sagging, and one of the wooden posts had cracked.

3 Ada knew the morning wagons would come soon. She ran to the mayor's house, but no one answered. Without wasting another minute, she dragged her family's old red blanket to the end of the bridge and tied it to the railing like a flag. Then she stood beside it, waving her arms.

4 When the first farmer arrived, he grumbled at being stopped. But when he saw the cracked post, his face went pale. Minutes later, with a loud groan, the middle of the bridge fell into the river.

5 The town built a new stone bridge that summer. On the first day it opened, the mayor tied a red ribbon across it. Instead of cutting it himself, he handed the scissors to Ada.

1 Why did people cross the bridge every morning?

A to fish
B to sell vegetables and go to school
C to see the mayor

2 What did Ada notice about the bridge? Quote the text.

3 Why did Ada tie the blanket to the railing? Make an inference and give a clue.

4 How did the farmer feel when he saw the cracked post? Clue?

5 What does “Without wasting another minute” show about Ada?

A She was lazy.

B She acted quickly in an emergency.

C She was confused.

Part B · Theme and summary (1 point each)

6 What is a theme of “The Bridge at Millbrook”?

7 Why did the mayor give Ada the scissors? What does this show?

8 Explain one cause-and-effect relationship in the story.

9 Which detail does NOT belong in a summary?

A Ada warned people about the bridge.

B The blanket was red.

C The bridge fell into the river.

Part C · Write (5 points)

10 Write a summary paragraph of “The Bridge at Millbrook” with a topic sentence, the key events in order, and a concluding sentence. Then add one sentence stating the theme.

UNIT 3

Reading Longer Texts

Stamina, annotation, point of view, tracking evidence, inference, and organized written responses, with King Arthur Chapters 9–12.

Your practice pages for Unit 3. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

stamina	Ability to keep going.
annotate	Mark a text while reading.
narrator	The voice telling the story.
synthesize	Combine information.
reasoning	How evidence supports an idea.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.1 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.1: Building Reading Stamina

Name _____ Date _____

I can read a longer text by breaking it into chunks and checking my understanding.

Warm-Up

1. What is a chunk?

2. What is the gist?

Read and Chunk

ADVENTURE STORY

The Secret of Hollow Hill · Part 1

An original story in three parts

1 Nobody in the village of Thornbury went near Hollow Hill. The grown-ups said the hill was dangerous, though none of them could say exactly why. Children whispered that a dragon slept beneath it, or a giant, or the ghost of a wicked king.

2 Eleven-year-old Pip didn't believe in dragons. She believed in maps. Her grandfather had been the village mapmaker, and when he died, he left Pip his drawings, his compass, and a small brass key with no lock to fit it.

3 One rainy afternoon, Pip spread Grandfather's oldest map across the kitchen table. In the corner, in faded ink, she noticed something she had never seen before: a tiny drawing of a door on the side of Hollow Hill. Beneath it, Grandfather had written three words: For Pip. Courage.

4 Pip's heart beat faster. She ran her finger over the words again and again. Grandfather had known she would find this. But why hadn't he told her?

5 That night, she could hardly sleep. Each time she closed her eyes, she saw the little door. By morning, she had made up her mind. She packed bread, a candle, the compass, and the brass key, and she slipped out of the house before anyone else was awake.

6 Fog lay over the fields like a gray blanket. As Pip walked, the village roosters began to crow behind her. Ahead, Hollow Hill rose dark and silent. Her legs felt heavy, and twice she almost turned back. Then she remembered the words on the map. Courage. She kept walking.

3 Write the gist of each chunk: paragraphs 1–2, 3–4, 5–6.

4 Why does Pip almost turn back? What keeps her going?

Chapter 9

5 Write the gist of the first half and the second half of Chapter 9.

Exit Ticket

6 Which chunking strategy helped you most today? Why?

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.2 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.2: Annotating a Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can annotate a text by marking important ideas, questions, and new words.

Warm-Up

1. What does annotate mean?

2. What symbol marks a new word?

Annotate Part 2

ADVENTURE STORY

The Secret of Hollow Hill · Part 2

An original story in three parts

1 Thorny bushes covered the side of the hill. Pip pushed through them, scratching her arms, until she found a gray stone almost hidden in the weeds. Carved into the stone was a keyhole.

2 Her hands shook as she pulled out the brass key. It slid in perfectly. With a loud click, the stone swung inward, and cool air rushed out of a dark tunnel.

3 Pip lit her candle. The tunnel walls were smooth and dry, and someone had painted arrows on them in white paint. She followed the arrows deeper and deeper, counting her steps the way Grandfather had taught her. Two hundred steps. Three hundred.

4 At last the tunnel opened into a round room. Pip gasped. The walls were covered with maps, hundreds of them, showing rivers, forests, roads, and towns, some she knew and some she had never heard of. In the middle of the room stood a wooden desk, and on the desk lay a letter with her name on it.

5 Dear Pip, the letter began. For fifty years, I have mapped every corner of this valley. I kept this room secret because I was afraid people would laugh at an old man who spent his life drawing. But you never laughed. You asked questions. Now this room is yours. Please don't let my work stay hidden in the dark.

6 Pip read the letter three times. Then she sat down at Grandfather's desk and cried, but they were not entirely sad tears.

3 Annotate Part 2 using the symbols. Then list one thing you underlined, one question, and one surprise.

4 Why did Grandfather keep the room secret? Quote the letter.

5 Why does Pip cry “not entirely sad tears”?

Exit Ticket

6 How did annotating help you answer the questions?

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.3 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.3: Fix-Up Strategies

Name _____ Date _____

I can notice when I'm confused and use a strategy to fix it.

Warm-Up

1. What does monitor mean?

2. Name one fix-up strategy.

Read Part 3

ADVENTURE STORY

The Secret of Hollow Hill · Part 3

An original story in three parts

1 When Pip returned to Thornbury, the whole village was searching for her. Her mother hugged her so hard she could barely breathe. Then, of course, came the scolding.

2 "Hollow Hill?" the mayor sputtered. "That hill is dangerous!"

3 "It isn't," Pip said quietly. "There's nothing dangerous inside. Only maps." And she told them everything.

4 At first, people didn't believe her. So the next day, Pip led a group of villagers through the thorny bushes and into the tunnel. When they saw the round room, no one said a word. Old Mrs. Barrow touched a map of her family's farm, drawn more carefully than any she had ever seen, and her eyes filled with tears.

5 That spring, the villagers carried Grandfather's maps down from Hollow Hill and hung them in the town hall. Travelers came from far away to see them. The mayor named the room the Mapmaker's Library and asked Pip to be its keeper.

6 Children in Thornbury still whisper about Hollow Hill. But now, instead of dragons, they talk about a girl who was brave enough to follow a map, and a grandfather who was brave enough, in the end, to share his work.

3 Why didn't people believe Pip at first? How did she prove it?

4 How did the village change by the end?

5 Write about one place in Part 3 that confused you and the strategy you used.

Exit Ticket

6 Retell the whole story of Hollow Hill in three sentences.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.4 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.4: Narrator and Point of View

Name _____ Date _____

I can tell whether a story is told in first person or third person and explain how it affects what we learn.

Warm-Up

1. Pronouns in first person

2. Pronouns in third person

Which Point of View?

3. "I grabbed my sword and ran."

4. "Arthur grabbed his sword and ran."

5. "We laughed until our sides hurt."

6. "The children laughed until their sides hurt."

Rewrite

7. Rewrite Hollow Hill Part 1, paragraph 4, in first person, as if Pip is telling it.

8. What can a first-person narrator NOT tell readers?

Exit Ticket

9. Why might an author choose first person for a scary story?

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Dec 18 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 7: Reading Longer Texts

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

PERSONAL NARRATIVE

The Bravest Thing

An original personal narrative

1 I had never been on a stage before. My mouth felt as dry as sand, and my knees knocked together under my costume.

2 My line was only four words: “The king is coming!” I had practiced it a hundred times. But when the spotlight hit my face, my mind went blank.

3 Then I saw my best friend, Lucas, in the front row. He gave me a thumbs-up. I took a breath and shouted my line so loudly that the audience laughed. I didn't care. I had done it.

1 What point of view is this story told from?

A first person
B third person

2 Write the gist of paragraph 2.

3 Explain the simile “My mouth felt as dry as sand.”

4 What helped the narrator say the line? Give evidence.

5 Why does the narrator say “I didn't care” when the audience laughed?

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.5 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.5: Tracking a Character Across a Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can track how a character changes across a long text using evidence from several places.

Warm-Up

1. What is character change?

2. Why use a tracking chart?

Track Galahad

3. Fill in: beginning of Chapter 10, what Galahad does or how others see him:

4. Middle:

5. End:

6. What do these details show about Galahad?

Exit Ticket

7. In one sentence, explain how Pip changes, using one detail from the beginning and one from the end.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.6 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.6: Explaining Events and Procedures

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain what happened and why in an informational text, using specific details.

Warm-Up

1. What is a procedure?

2. Name two sequence words.

Explain the Procedure

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

How a Medieval Cathedral Was Built

An original informational text

1 Cathedrals were the largest buildings in medieval Europe. Some took more than a hundred years to finish, which meant that the workers who began a cathedral often did not live to see it completed.

2 First, a master builder drew the plans. He decided how tall the walls would be, where the windows would go, and how the roof would be supported. There were no computers, so he used simple tools like string, compasses, and rulers.

3 Next, workers dug deep trenches for the foundation. The foundation had to be strong enough to hold up thousands of tons of stone, so it was sometimes dug as deep as the walls were tall.

4 Then the stonecutters went to work. In the quarry, they cut huge blocks of stone and shaped them with hammers and chisels. Each block was marked with the stonecutter's own symbol so he could be paid for his work.

5 As the walls rose, carpenters built wooden scaffolds, frames that workers stood on to reach high places. Large wheels called treadwheels, powered by men walking inside them like hamsters, lifted the heavy stones into place.

6 Finally, glassmakers created stained-glass windows. They colored glass with metals, cut it into pieces, and joined the pieces with strips of lead to make pictures. When sunlight shone through, the inside of the cathedral glowed with color.

7 Today, many medieval cathedrals are still standing. They remind us what people could build with patience, teamwork, and simple tools.

3 List the steps of building a cathedral in order (at least five).

4 Explain how workers lifted heavy stones high into the walls. Use two details.

5 Why did some workers never see their cathedral finished?

Exit Ticket

6 Explain how stained-glass windows were made in your own words.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.7 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.7: Connecting Evidence from Several Paragraphs

Name _____ Date _____

I can combine evidence from different parts of a text to answer a big question.

Warm-Up

1. Synthesize means...

2. How many paragraphs for a big question?

Synthesize

3. Big question: Why is “Courage” the right word for Grandfather's note? Use evidence from Parts 1, 2, and 3 of Hollow Hill.

Chapter 10 Connection

4. How do the knights of the Round Table treat Galahad? Use evidence from two places in Chapter 10.

Exit Ticket

5 Write one big question about the King Arthur Reader that needs evidence from more than one chapter.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.8 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.8: Writing with Evidence from Across a Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can write a paragraph that uses evidence from at least two parts of a text.

Warm-Up

1. ACE: A =

2. A transition for the end of a story

Write

3. How does the village of Thornbury change across the story? Write an ACE paragraph with two pieces of evidence from different parts.

Exit Ticket

4. Underline the transitions you used.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Jan 8 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 8: Tracking Evidence

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Beavers: Nature's Engineers

An original informational text

1 Beavers are some of the best builders in the animal world. They use their sharp front teeth to cut down trees, sometimes chewing through a trunk in a single night.

2 First, beavers build a dam across a stream. They pile up branches, rocks, and mud until the water backs up into a pond.

3 Next, they build a home called a lodge in the middle of the pond. The lodge has underwater entrances, so wolves and other predators cannot easily get in.

4 The pond a beaver makes helps other animals too. Fish, frogs, ducks, and insects move into the new wetland. In this way, one family of beavers can change a whole stream.

1. List the steps beavers follow to build their home, in order.

2. Why does the lodge have underwater entrances?

3. Use evidence from two paragraphs to explain why beavers are called “engineers.”

4. How do beavers help other animals?

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.9 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.9: Inferences and Predictions

Name _____ Date _____

I can make predictions and inferences and revise them as I read.

Warm-Up

1 A prediction is a kind of...

2 Can predictions change?

Chapter 11

3 What is the quest? What clues tell you it will be hard?

4 Make a prediction about which knight will succeed. Give a clue.

Prediction Log

5 Prediction:

6 Clue:

7 After reading: confirmed or revised? Why?

Exit Ticket

8 Why is it okay for a prediction to be wrong?

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.10 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.10: Inferring the Theme of a Longer Story

Name _____ Date _____

I can infer the theme of a longer story using evidence from the whole text.

Warm-Up

1. Topic of Hollow Hill

2. Can a story have more than one theme?

Theme with Evidence

3. Write a theme for "The Secret of Hollow Hill." Support it with evidence from two different parts.

Chapter 11 Connection

4. What theme might the quest in Chapter 11 be building? Explain.

Exit Ticket

5. How does the title "The Secret of Hollow Hill" connect to the theme?

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.11 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.11: Inferring the Author's Ideas in Informational Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can infer what an author thinks about a topic from the details and words chosen.

Warm-Up

1 What is an author's point?

2 Where do authors often state their main point?

Infer the Author's Ideas

3 Reread “Honeybees in Winter” (Lesson 2.7). What does the author want readers to understand about honeybees? Give evidence.

4 What does the author of “The Printing Press” (Lesson 2.14) think about the invention? Quote a word or phrase.

Exit Ticket

5 Write a sentence about a topic you love using a word that shows your opinion.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.12 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.12: Explaining an Inference in Writing

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain an inference in a paragraph with two pieces of evidence and clear reasoning.

Warm-Up

1 What is reasoning?

2 Inference = clues + ?

Write

3 Why did Grandfather leave the room to Pip instead of to the mayor or the village? Write an inference paragraph with two pieces of evidence and strong reasoning.

Exit Ticket

4 Highlight your best reasoning sentence and explain why it is strong.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Jan 15 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 9: Inference

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

REALISTIC FICTION

The Empty Chair

An original story

1 Every Sunday, Grandpa Joe set five places at the dinner table, even though only four people came. Nobody ever sat in the fifth chair.

2 When Lena asked why, Grandpa just smiled and passed the potatoes. But she noticed that he always glanced at the door when the wind rattled it.

3 One Sunday, there was a knock. Grandpa jumped up so fast his napkin fell to the floor. In the doorway stood a tall man in a soldier's uniform. Grandpa hugged him for a long time without saying anything. That night, all five chairs were full.

1. Why do you think Grandpa set a fifth place? Give two clues.

2. Who is the man at the door likely to be? Explain your reasoning.

3. How does Grandpa feel when he sees the man? Evidence?

4 What is the best theme?

A Dinner is important.

B Hope can keep a family together while they wait.

C Soldiers wear uniforms.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.13 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.13: Understanding the Prompt

Name _____ Date _____

I can break down a writing prompt to understand exactly what it asks.

Warm-Up

1 What does a prompt do?

2 A task word

Break It Down

3 "Describe how cathedrals were built. Include at least three steps." Task: ___ Topic: ___ Requirements: ___

4 "Compare Sir Gawaine and Galahad. Use evidence from Chapters 10–12." Task: ___ Topic: ___ Requirements: ___

5 "Explain why the villagers changed their minds about Hollow Hill." Task: ___ Topic: ___ Requirements: ___

Chapter 12

6 What choices does Gawaine make on the quest? Give one detail.

Exit Ticket

7 Restate this prompt in your own words: “Explain what the quest shows about the knights of the Round Table.”

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.14 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.14: Planning an Organized Response

Name _____ Date _____

I can plan a multi-paragraph response with an introduction, body, and conclusion.

Warm-Up

1 First paragraph =

2 Last paragraph =

Plan Your Response

3 Prompt: Explain what the quest for the Grail shows about the knights of the Round Table. Use evidence from Chapters 11–12. Introduction (answer):

4 Body 1 (point + evidence):

5 Body 2 (point + evidence):

6 Conclusion:

Exit Ticket

7 Which part of your plan is strongest? Which needs more evidence?

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.15 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.15: Drafting the Response

Name _____ Date _____

I can draft a multi-paragraph response from my plan.

Warm-Up

1. Transition to start body 1

2. Transition for the conclusion

Draft

3 Draft your response to the quest prompt from Lesson 3.14.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.16 · PRACTICE

Lesson 3.16: Revising for Organization

Name _____ Date _____

I can revise my response for clear organization, evidence, and transitions.

Warm-Up

1. Revising is about...

2. Editing is about...

Revise Your Draft

3. Use the checklist on your Lesson 3.15 draft. List two changes you made.

4. Copy your strongest sentence of explanation.

Exit Ticket

5. What did you learn about writing longer responses this unit?

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Jan 21 (homework) or as needed · ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Unit 3 Review

Name _____ Date _____

Skills

1. What is the gist?

2. Symbol for a question while annotating

3. First-person pronouns

4. Name two fix-up strategies

5. Parts of an organized response

6. Task word in “Explain why…”

Apply

7. Reread “How a Medieval Cathedral Was Built.” Explain why scaffolds were needed.

8. Plan (don't write) an organized response to: “Explain how Grandfather's letter changes the story.”

UNIT TEST · Fri Jan 22 · ABOUT 50 MINUTES

Unit 3 Test

Name _____ Date _____

Show your work. This test has 15 points.

Part A · Reading a longer text (1 point each)

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

The Night of the Great Fire

An original informational text based on historical facts

1 In 1871, the city of Chicago was mostly made of wood. Houses, sidewalks, barns, and even some streets were wooden. That summer had been the driest anyone could remember. Only an inch of rain had fallen since July.

2 On the night of October 8, a fire started in a barn on the southwest side of the city. No one knows for sure how it began. Strong winds from the southwest pushed the flames toward the center of the city, and the fire spread from one wooden building to the next.

3 The city's firefighters worked all night, but they had only a few horse-drawn engines. The fire jumped across the Chicago River and kept going. Burning bits of wood flew through the air and started new fires blocks away.

4 Thousands of people ran from their homes carrying whatever they could. Some waded into Lake Michigan to escape the heat. When rain finally fell on the night of October 9, the fire had burned for more than a day.

5 The Great Chicago Fire destroyed about 17,000 buildings and left about 100,000 people homeless. Yet Chicago did not give up. People rebuilt the city, this time using more brick, stone, and iron. Within twenty years, Chicago was one of the largest and most modern cities in the country.

6 Today, a star on Chicago's flag stands for the Great Fire. It reminds people that the city rose from the ashes stronger than before.

1 Write the gist of paragraph 1.

2 Explain why the fire spread so quickly. Use evidence from two paragraphs.

3 What point of view is this text written in?

A first person

B third person

4 What did people do to escape the heat?

5 How was the rebuilt city different? Why?

Part B · Inference (1 point each)

6 What can you infer about Chicago's firefighters in 1871? Give a clue.

7 What is the author's point in the last two paragraphs? Quote a phrase.

8 Which conclusion is BEST supported?

A The fire was caused by a cow.

B Chicago's people were determined to rebuild.

C Chicago never recovered.

Part C · Organized response (6 points)

9 Prompt: Explain how the Great Chicago Fire changed the city. Write an introduction, two body paragraphs with evidence, and a conclusion.

UNIT 4

The Writer's Craft

Words and phrases, structure, purpose and point of view, and comparing texts, with Treasure Island Chapters 1–4.

Your practice pages for Unit 4. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

allusion	A reference to a well-known story.
mood	The feeling a text creates.
stage directions	Notes telling actors what to do.
text structure	How information is organized.
firsthand account	Told by someone who was there.
suspense	Worry about what happens next.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.1 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.1: Reading Old-Fashioned Language

Name _____ Date _____

I can figure out the meaning of words and phrases in an older text.

Warm-Up

1. What is a classic?

2. When was Treasure Island written?

Old Words, New Meanings

CLASSIC NOVEL EXCERPT

From Treasure Island, Chapter 1 (original 1883 text)

Robert Louis Stevenson, Treasure Island (1883). Public domain.

1 Squire Trelawney, Dr. Livesey, and the rest of these gentlemen having asked me to write down the whole particulars about Treasure Island, from the beginning to the end, keeping nothing back but the bearings of the island, and that only because there is still treasure not yet lifted, I take up my pen in the year of grace 17—, and go back to the time when my father kept the Admiral Benbow inn, and the brown old seaman, with the sabre cut, first took up his lodging under our roof.

2 I remember him as if it were yesterday, as he came plodding to the inn door, his sea-chest following behind him in a hand-barrow—a tall, strong, heavy, nut-brown man, his tarry pigtail falling over the shoulder of his soiled blue coat, his hands ragged and scarred, with black, broken nails, and the sabre cut across one cheek, a dirty, livid white.

3. Paragraph 2: list four details that describe the seaman. What kind of person does he seem to be?

4. What does “plodding” mean? Which clue helps?

5 "The year of grace 17—" tells us the story happened...

A in the future

B in the 1700s

C last year

Chapter 1

6 What is the black spot, and why does it frighten the captain?

Exit Ticket

7 Rewrite paragraph 2 in one modern sentence.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.2 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.2: Words from Mythology

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain words and phrases that come from mythology.

Warm-Up

1 What is an allusion?

2 Who was Hercules?

Use the Allusion

3 Spelling is my Achilles' heel. This means spelling is...

A my best subject
B my weak spot
C very easy

4 Starting that argument opened a Pandora's box. This means...

A it caused many problems
B it was a gift
C it was fun

5 Moving the piano was a Herculean task. This means...

A it was easy
B it needed great strength
C it was musical

6 Grandpa has the Midas touch with his business. This means...

A his business fails
B he is good at making money
C he likes gold jewelry

Write

7 Write two sentences of your own using two of the allusions.

Exit Ticket

8 Which allusion describes the captain in Chapter 1? Explain.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.3 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.3: Sensory Language and Mood

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how sensory words create a mood.

Warm-Up

1 Five senses

2 A mood word

Use the Poem

POEM

The Sea Chest

An original poem

The old sea chest sat by the door,
Its lid all cracked and worn;
It smelled of salt and tar and rope
And stormy seas at morn.

What secrets did the sailor keep
Beneath that rusty lock?
A compass, coins, a faded map,
A single, tangled sock?

I'll never know, for on the night
The sailor sailed away,
He took his chest and all his tales
To some far-distant bay.

3 List three sensory details from the poem and the sense each appeals to.

4 The poet ends the second stanza with “A single, tangled sock?” How does this line change the mood?

Chapter 1

5 Find a sensory detail in Chapter 1 that creates a scary or tense mood. Explain.

Exit Ticket

6 Write two sentences describing the Admiral Benbow inn at night with a spooky mood. Use two senses.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.4 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.4: Content Words in Informational Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can figure out content words in an informational text.

Warm-Up

1. Front of a ship

2. Back of a ship

Content Words

3. port

4. starboard

5. mast

6. deck

7. galley

8. rigging

Label the Ship

9. Draw a simple ship from above. Label the bow, stern, port, and starboard.

Exit Ticket

10 Write two sentences about a sailor's day using three content words.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Jan 29 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 10: Words and Phrases

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

REALISTIC FICTION

The Lighthouse at Gull Point

An original story

1 Gull Point Lighthouse stood like a giant candle at the edge of the cliff. Its beam swept the black water, a white finger pointing ships to safety.

2 Mr. Fenn, the keeper, had a heart of gold, but his temper was a volcano. When the gulls stole his sandwiches, he roared so loudly that the whole island heard him.

3 Still, every night for forty years, he climbed the 120 stairs to light the lamp. It was a Herculean job, but he never missed a night.

1. "The lighthouse stood like a giant candle." Simile or metaphor? What does it mean?

2. What does "a heart of gold" mean?

3. "His temper was a volcano." What does this tell you about Mr. Fenn?

4. Why is climbing 120 stairs every night called "Herculean"?

5. What mood does the first paragraph create?

A silly
B calm and steady
C angry

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.5 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.5: Poems, Drama, and Prose

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how poems, drama, and prose are structured differently.

Warm-Up

1. A group of lines in a poem

2. Notes telling actors what to do

Identify Structures

3. Lines with rhyme in stanzas

4. JIM: Who's there?

5. Paragraphs with a narrator

6. (She slams the door.)

Compare

DRAMA

The Captain's Warning: A Scene

An original scene inspired by Treasure Island

CHARACTERS: JIM, a boy who works at the inn · THE CAPTAIN, an old sailor · MOTHER, Jim's mother

(The Admiral Benbow inn. Night. Wind howls outside. THE CAPTAIN sits by the fire, gripping his mug.)

CAPTAIN: *(in a low voice)* Jim, come here, lad. You keep your weather-eye open, you hear?

JIM: For what, Captain?

CAPTAIN: For a seafaring man with one leg. If you see him, you tell me first. I'll pay you a silver fourpenny every month.

MOTHER: *(entering with a tray)* Jim! Stop bothering the guest and fetch more wood.

JIM: *(to the audience)* But I couldn't stop thinking about that one-legged man. That night, I dreamed of him chasing me across the moor.

7 How does the scene show the captain's fear differently from a prose narrator? Use one stage direction.

Exit Ticket

8 Write two lines of a play showing Jim and his mother opening the sea chest in Chapter 2. Include a stage direction.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.6 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.6: Writing a Scene: From Story to Drama

Name _____ Date _____

I can turn a scene from a story into drama.

Warm-Up

1. Two parts of drama

2. Punctuation for stage directions

Write a Scene

3. Turn a moment from Chapter 2 into a short play scene (8–12 lines). Include a cast list, a setting stage direction, dialogue, and at least two more stage directions.

Exit Ticket

4 What was hardest about turning prose into drama?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.7 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.7: Informational Text Structures

Name _____ Date _____

I can identify how an informational text is organized.

Warm-Up

1 Signal word for contrast

2 Signal word for cause

Name the Structure

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Four Paragraphs About Life at Sea

Original informational paragraphs

1 The pirate Blackbeard began sailing around 1716. By 1717, he had captured a large French ship and renamed it Queen Anne's Revenge. In 1718, he blockaded the port of Charleston. Later that year, he was defeated in a battle off the coast of North Carolina.

2 Pirates and navy sailors both lived on ships and faced storms and disease. However, navy sailors worked for a government and were paid regular wages. Pirates, on the other hand, often voted for their captain and shared the treasure they stole.

3 Because sailors ate few fruits and vegetables on long voyages, many developed a disease called scurvy. As a result, their gums bled and they grew weak. When sailors began carrying limes and lemons, scurvy became much less common.

4 Ships often wrecked on rocky coasts at night. To solve this problem, people built lighthouses with bright lamps on high towers. The light warned sailors to steer away from danger.

3 Paragraph 1: Which structure?

A chronological
B compare and contrast
C cause and effect
D problem and solution

4 Paragraph 2: Which structure?

A chronological
B compare and contrast
C cause and effect
D problem and solution

5 Paragraph 3: Which structure?

A chronological
B compare and contrast
C cause and effect
D problem and solution

6 Paragraph 4: Which structure?

A chronological
B compare and contrast
C cause and effect
D problem and solution

Signal Words

7 Copy two signal words from paragraph 2 and two from paragraph 1.

Exit Ticket

8 Which structure does “How a Medieval Cathedral Was Built” (Lesson 3.6) mostly use? How do you know?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.8 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.8: Text Structures and Graphic Organizers

Name _____ Date _____

I can use a graphic organizer that matches a text's structure to take notes.

Warm-Up

1. Organizer for problem/solution

2. Organizer for chronological

Make Organizers

3. Make a cause → effect chain for paragraph 3 (scurvy).

4. Make problem/solution boxes for paragraph 4 (lighthouses).

Chapter 2

5. Make a timeline of three to four events in Chapter 2.

Exit Ticket

6 Which organizer helps you study best? Why?

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Feb 5 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 11: Text Structure

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

DRAMA

Moving Day

An original scene

(A kitchen full of boxes. MAYA, age 10, sits on a box, arms crossed. DAD tapes another box shut.)

DAD: Maya, can you hand me the markers?

MAYA: *(not moving)* I don't want to move. All my friends are here.

DAD: *(sitting down beside her)* I know. I was scared to move when I was your age, too. But I met my best friend in the new town.

MAYA: *(uncrossing her arms)* Really? *(pause)* Okay. Which box do the markers go in?

1. This text is an example of...

A prose
B a poem
C drama

2. Copy one stage direction.

3. How do the stage directions show Maya's feelings change?

4. Why does Maya change her mind? Use evidence.

5 Which structure fits this sentence: “Because it rained, the game was canceled”?

A chronological

B compare and contrast

C cause and effect

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.9 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.9: Author's Purpose

Name _____ Date _____

I can identify an author's purpose and explain how I know.

Warm-Up

1 P-I-E stands for

2 Purpose of a recipe

What's the Purpose?

3 A poster: "Vote for Maria for class president!"

4 An article on how volcanoes form

5 A funny story about a talking parrot

6 A letter asking the mayor to build a park

Use the Ad

PERSUASIVE TEXT

WANTED: Brave Sailors!

An original advertisement

1 Are you tired of boring work on land? Join the crew of the finest ship in Bristol, the Hispaniola!

2 Our ship is fast, our captain is fair, and our cook makes the best stew on the seven seas. Every sailor will be paid well, and the voyage will be the adventure of a lifetime.

3 Don't miss this chance. Only the bravest need apply. Sign up at the docks today!

7 What does the ad leave out that a sailor might want to know? Why might the writer leave it out?

Exit Ticket

8 What is the purpose of Treasure Island? Explain.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.10 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.10: Firsthand and Secondhand Accounts

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare a firsthand and a secondhand account of the same event.

Warm-Up

1 Pronouns in a firsthand account

2 Is an encyclopedia firsthand?

Compare the Accounts

3 What does Account A tell you that Account B does not?

4 What does Account B tell you that Account A does not?

5 Why is it useful to read both?

Chapter 3

6 Is Treasure Island told as a firsthand or secondhand account? How do you know?

Exit Ticket

7 Write two sentences giving a firsthand account of something that happened this week.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.11 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.11: Characters' Points of View

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how different characters see the same events differently.

Warm-Up

1 What is perspective?

2 Narrator of Treasure Island

Two Perspectives

3 Chapter 2: How might Jim's mother describe the night the pirates came differently from Jim?

4 Chapter 3: Compare how the squire and the doctor react to the treasure map. Give evidence for each.

Exit Ticket

5 Retell one event from Chapter 3 from the squire's point of view in two sentences.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.12 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.12: Facts, Opinions, and Persuasive Language

Name _____ Date _____

I can tell facts from opinions and recognize persuasive techniques.

Warm-Up

1. Can a fact be proved?

2. A call to action

Fact or Opinion?

3. Treasure Island was published in 1883.

4. Treasure Island is the most exciting book ever.

5. Pirates attacked ships carrying gold.

6. Pirates were the coolest people in history.

7. A ship's kitchen is called a galley.

8. Hard biscuits taste awful.

Write

9. Rewrite the sailor ad as an honest, informational notice with only facts.

Exit Ticket

10. Write one fact and one opinion about Long John Silver.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Feb 12 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 12: Purpose and Point of View

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

JOURNAL

Ellie's Journal: The Science Fair

An original firsthand account

1 March 3. Today was the science fair! I was so nervous my hands shook while I set up my volcano. When I poured in the vinegar, the lava bubbled over perfectly, and the judges laughed and clapped.

2 I won second place! I can't wait to tell Grandma. Next year, I want to build a robot.

1. This journal is a...
   A firsthand account
   B secondhand account

2. What clue tells you?

3. Write one fact and one opinion from the journal.

4. What is the main purpose of a journal entry?
   A to persuade
   B to record and share personal experiences
   C to sell something

5. How would a newspaper article about the science fair be different?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.13 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.13: How Authors Build Suspense

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how an author builds suspense with word choice and structure.

Warm-Up

1 What is suspense?

2 What is a cliffhanger?

Use the Passage

REALISTIC FICTION

The Footsteps

An original story

1 Ana was alone in the library after closing. The lights buzzed. Rain tapped the tall windows.

2 Then she heard it: a footstep. Then another. Slow. Heavy. Coming closer.

3 She held her breath and crouched behind the shelf of atlases. The footsteps stopped right beside her. A shadow stretched across the floor.

4 "Ana?" said a familiar voice. It was Mr. Diaz, the custodian, holding an umbrella. "Your mom is waiting outside." Ana let out her breath in a laugh so loud it echoed off the ceiling.

3 List three techniques the author uses to build suspense. Give an example of each.

4 Why does the author have Ana laugh at the end?

Chapter 4

5 What does Jim overhear in the apple barrel? How does the author make the moment tense?

Exit Ticket

6 Write a two-sentence cliffhanger.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.14 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.14: Comparing Text and Illustration

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare a text with an illustration or performance of it.

Warm-Up

1 What is an illustration?

2 Movie of a book: does it always match?

Compare

3 Choose an illustration from Chapters 1–4 of your Reader. List two details that match the text.

4 List one thing the illustrator added or changed.

5 Draw your own picture of Long John Silver using details from Chapter 3 or 4. Label two details from the text.

Exit Ticket

6 Listen to someone read part of Chapter 4 aloud with expression. What did their voice add that the page alone doesn't?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.15 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.15: Comparing Fiction and Nonfiction on the Same Topic

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare how a story and an informational text treat the same topic.

Warm-Up

1. Fiction or nonfiction: Treasure Island

2. Fiction or nonfiction: "Real Pirates"

Compare

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Real Pirates of the Golden Age

An original informational text

1 From about 1690 to 1730, so many pirates sailed the oceans that historians call it the Golden Age of Piracy. Pirates attacked ships carrying gold, silver, sugar, and cloth.

2 Real pirates were very different from the pirates in stories. Most did not bury their treasure; they spent it quickly. There is little evidence that pirates made prisoners walk the plank. And treasure maps marked with an X were mostly invented by writers.

3 Pirate ships often had written rules. Crews voted on important decisions, and treasure was divided by shares. A captain who was unfair could be voted out.

4 Life as a pirate was dangerous and usually short. Many pirates were captured and punished. By 1730, navies had driven most pirates from the seas.

3. How are Long John Silver's plans similar to what real pirates did?

4 Name one way Treasure Island differs from real pirate history. Use evidence from the informational text.

Exit Ticket

5 Why do you think writers invented buried treasure and treasure maps?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.16 · PRACTICE

Lesson 4.16: Writing a Comparison Paragraph

Name _____ Date _____

I can write a paragraph comparing two texts.

Warm-Up

1. Transition for similarity

2. Transition for difference

Write

3. Compare Account A and Account B (Lesson 4.10) OR Treasure Island and "Real Pirates." Write a comparison paragraph with evidence from both texts.

Exit Ticket

4. Which skill from this unit will help you most as a writer?

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Feb 18 (homework) or as needed · ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Unit 4 Review

Name _____ Date _____

Skills

1. Achilles' heel means

2. Structure with “however” and “both”

3. Part of a play telling actors what to do

4. PIE

5. Firsthand pronouns

6. Two suspense techniques

Apply

7. Reread “The Footsteps.” Turn the last paragraph into two lines of drama with a stage direction.

8. Write a topic sentence comparing how “The Footsteps” and “The Captain's Warning” build suspense.

UNIT TEST · Fri Feb 19 · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Unit 4 Test

Name _____ Date _____

Show your work. This test has 15 points.

Part A · Words and craft (1 point each)

ADVENTURE STORY

Ghost Ship of the Fog

An original story

1 The fog rolled in thick and gray, swallowing the harbor whole. On the deck of the fishing boat Mary Bell, Captain Rosa squinted into the mist. Her crew had gone silent.

2 Then, out of the fog, a ship appeared. Its sails hung in rags, and its wooden sides were green with moss. No lanterns burned on its deck. No sailors called out. It drifted toward them without a sound.

3 "A ghost ship," whispered Tomás, the youngest sailor, gripping the rail so tightly his knuckles turned white. "My grandmother told me about them."

4 Captain Rosa's heart pounded, but her voice was steady. "Hard to starboard!" she ordered. The Mary Bell turned, and the old ship slid past, so close that Rosa could read the faded name on its stern: Restless.

5 The next day, Rosa learned the truth. The Restless was an old ship that had broken loose from its anchor in a storm. With no crew aboard, it had drifted for weeks. It wasn't haunted after all, though Tomás never quite believed that.

1. "The fog rolled in thick and gray, swallowing the harbor whole." What does "swallowing" mean here?

2. List two sensory details in paragraph 2 and the mood they create.

3 Explain two techniques the author uses to build suspense in paragraphs 1–3.

4 “Hard to starboard!” means turn the ship…

A left
B right
C around backward

5 What does Tomás's grip on the rail show?

Part B · Structure and point of view (1 point each)

6 This story is told in…

A first person
B third person

7 How does the last paragraph change the mood?

8 How do Captain Rosa and Tomás see the ship differently?

9 What is the author's main purpose?

A to persuade
B to inform
C to entertain

Part C · Write (5 points)

10 Rewrite paragraphs 3–4 as a short drama scene with a cast list, stage directions, and dialogue. Then write one sentence explaining what the stage directions show about the characters.

UNIT 5

Reading Deeply

Long stories and articles, text features, comparing structure and viewpoint, and the comparison essay, with Treasure Island Chapters 5–7.

Your practice pages for Unit 5. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

climax	The turning point of a plot.
characterization	How an author shows what a character is like.
text features	Headings, captions, bold words, and visuals.
epistolary	Told through letters or journals.
thesis	The main claim of an essay.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.1 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.1: Plot Structure

Name _____ Date _____

I can identify the parts of a plot in a longer story.

Warm-Up

1. The turning point is the...

_____

2. The beginning that introduces characters is the...

_____

Map the Plot

ADVENTURE STORY

The Castaway of Pelican Key

An original story

1 The storm had wrecked the little supply boat, and when Eli woke, he was lying on warm sand with seaweed tangled in his hair. The boat was gone. The crew was gone. All he could see was a curve of white beach, a cluster of palm trees, and the endless blue ocean.

2 “Hello?” he called. Only the pelicans answered, squawking from the rocks.

3 For the first few days, Eli was too frightened to do anything but sit and stare at the horizon, hoping to see a sail. But his stomach growled, and his lips cracked from thirst. He knew that if he waited much longer, he would not survive.

4 So he made a plan. He followed the pelicans to a freshwater pool behind the rocks. He cracked coconuts with a heavy stone. He wove palm fronds into a roof and built a shelter against the cliff. Every morning, he scratched a line on a flat rock to count the days.

5 By the thirtieth line, Eli had become a different boy. His arms were brown and strong. He could catch fish with a sharpened stick and build a fire with dry grass and two stones. He even talked to the pelicans, naming the biggest one Captain.

6 Still, every evening, he climbed the cliff to watch the sea. And on the forty-second evening, he saw it: a white sail, tiny as a gull's feather, far out on the water.

7 Eli piled every branch he could find on the cliff top and lit the biggest fire he had ever made. Smoke climbed into the orange sky. The sail grew larger. It turned toward the island.

8 When the sailors rowed ashore, they found a tall, sunburned boy waiting on the beach with a pelican at his side. “We thought you were lost,” said the captain. Eli smiled. “I was,” he said. “But I found my way.”

3 Exposition:

4 Rising action (two events):

5 Climax:

6 Falling action:

7 Resolution:

Chapter 5

8 Describe the man Jim meets in Chapter 5. What is surprising about him?

Exit Ticket

9 Why does the story end with “I found my way”? What does Eli mean?

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.2 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.2: Analyzing a Character in Depth

Name _____ Date _____

I can describe a character in depth using what the character says, does, thinks, and how others react.

Warm-Up

1. S in STEAL

2. L in STEAL

STEAL Ben Gunn

3. Speech: what Ben Gunn says (Chapter 5)

4. Actions: what Ben Gunn does (Chapter 5)

5. Looks: what Ben Gunn looks like (Chapter 5)

6. Effect on others: what Ben Gunn makes Jim feel (Chapter 5)

Write

7 What kind of person is Ben Gunn? Use evidence from two STEAL categories.

Exit Ticket

8 Compare Eli and Ben Gunn in one sentence.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.3 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.3: How Setting Shapes a Story

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how the setting affects the characters and events.

Warm-Up

1 What is setting?

2 Setting of Treasure Island Ch. 5

Setting Analysis

3 Choose two details of the island setting in Chapter 5. Explain how each affects Jim or Ben Gunn.

4 How would Eli's story change if it took place in a snowy forest?

Exit Ticket

5 Why do you think so many adventure stories take place on islands?

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.4 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.4: Summarizing a Long Story

Name _____ Date _____

I can summarize a long story using its plot structure.

Warm-Up

1 Climax =

2 Resolution =

Summarize

3 Write a plot-arc summary of Treasure Island Chapters 1–5.

Exit Ticket

4 What's one detail you left out of your summary, and why?

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Feb 26 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 13: Plot and Character

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

REALISTIC FICTION

The Kite Contest

An original story

1 Every spring, Jada's town held a kite contest. This year she had built her own kite from sticks, newspaper, and an old red scarf.

2 On contest day, the wind was strong. The fancy store-bought kites soared high, and Jada's homemade kite crashed twice. Some kids laughed. Jada's cheeks burned, but she checked the knots, added a longer tail, and tried again.

3 The third time, the red kite climbed and climbed until it was higher than all the others. When the judges announced the prize for "Most Creative Kite," Jada's grin was wider than the sky.

1. What is the problem in the story?

2. What is the climax?

3. Use STEAL: what do Jada's actions show about her?

4. How does Jada feel when kids laugh? What clue shows it?

5 What is the resolution?

A The kite crashes.

B Jada wins Most Creative Kite.

C The wind is strong.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.5 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.5: Text Features

Name _____ Date _____

I can use text features to find and understand information.

Warm-Up

1. Words that explain a picture _____
2. A title for a section _____

Use the Features

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Finding the Way: How Sailors Navigated

An original informational text

Lost at Sea

Today, ships use satellites to know exactly where they are. But for most of history, sailors crossed oceans with no land in sight and no GPS. How did they find their way? They used the sky, simple tools, and a great deal of skill.

Reading the Stars

In the Northern Hemisphere, sailors relied on the North Star, also called Polaris. Unlike other stars, it barely moves across the night sky. By measuring how high Polaris was above the horizon, a navigator could tell how far north the ship was. This measurement is called latitude.

The Compass

A compass has a magnetized needle that always points north. Chinese inventors were using compasses by around 1100, and the tool soon spread to sailors in Europe. With a compass, sailors could keep a steady direction even on cloudy nights when the stars were hidden.

Measuring Speed

To figure out how fast a ship was moving, sailors tossed a piece of wood tied to a long rope over the side. The rope had knots tied at equal distances. A sailor counted how many knots slipped through his hands while a small sand timer ran out. That is why a ship's speed is still measured in knots today.

Putting It Together

By combining direction, speed, and time, a navigator could estimate the ship's position on a map. This method, called dead reckoning, was not perfect. A strong current or a storm could push a ship far off course. That is why sailors on long voyages always watched for birds, floating plants, and changes in the color of the water, all signs that land might be near.

3 List the five headings. Under which heading would you find information about storms pushing ships off course?

4 Why was the North Star useful? Use the text.

5 What is dead reckoning, and why wasn't it perfect?

Blackbeard

6 List three text features in the Blackbeard selection and what each taught you.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.6 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.6: Reading Charts, Diagrams, and Timelines

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how information in a chart, diagram, or timeline adds to a text.

Warm-Up

1 Rows and columns =

2 Events in order on a line =

Read the Visuals

3 Oldest tool on the chart

4 Tool for measuring speed

5 When was GPS developed?

6 How many years between the compass and the chronometer (about)?

Explain

7 How does the chart add to “Finding the Way”?

Exit Ticket

8 Make a three-event timeline of your own day.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.7 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.7: Main Ideas of Sections and the Whole Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can find the main idea of each section and of the whole text.

Warm-Up

1 Does each section have a main idea?

2 What connects section main ideas?

Blackbeard

3 Write the main idea of two sections of the Blackbeard selection.

4 Write the main idea of the whole selection.

Summary

5 Summarize "Finding the Way" in three sentences using the section main ideas.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.8 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.8: Integrating Information to Explain a Topic

Name _____ Date _____

I can combine information from a text and its visuals to explain a topic.

Warm-Up

1 Integrate means

2 Name one visual source

Write

3 Write an informational paragraph explaining how sailors found their way before GPS. Use at least one detail from the article and one from the chart or timeline.

Exit Ticket

4 Which detail from a visual did you use? Why was it helpful?

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Mar 5 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 14: Informational Text Features

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

The Monarch Migration

An original informational text

A Long Journey

Every fall, millions of monarch butterflies fly from Canada and the United States to forests in the mountains of Mexico. Some travel nearly 3,000 miles.

A Winter Home

In Mexico, the monarchs cluster together on fir trees, so many that the branches bend under their weight. The cool mountain air lets them rest without using up their energy.

Danger Ahead

Monarchs face many dangers, including the loss of milkweed, the only plant their caterpillars eat. Many people now plant milkweed in their gardens to help.

1. List the headings.

2. Under which heading would you learn why monarchs need help?

3. Why do monarchs rest in the cool mountains?

4. What is the main idea of the whole text?

5 What text feature could the author add to help readers? Explain.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.9 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.9: Comparing Story Structures

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare how two stories are structured and how the structure affects the reader.

Warm-Up

1 Epistolary means told through...

2 Structure of a play

Compare

EPISTOLARY STORY

Letters from Camp

An original story told in letters

July 2. Dear Mom and Dad, Camp is okay, I guess. The food is weird and my bunk is squeaky. A boy named Theo snores like a bear. I miss home. Love, Sam

July 5. Dear Mom and Dad, Today we went canoeing! Theo and I tipped over in the middle of the lake, and we laughed so hard we couldn't swim for a minute. The counselor said we were the soggiest team she'd ever seen. Love, Sam

July 9. Dear Mom and Dad, Can I stay for a second session? Theo is staying, and we're building a raft. Also, I don't even notice the squeaky bunk anymore. Love, Sam

3 How does Sam's attitude toward Theo change across the letters? Use evidence.

4 Compare the structures of “Letters from Camp” and “The Castaway.” How does each structure affect the reader?

Exit Ticket

5 Write a short diary entry as Jim Hawkins after Chapter 6.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.10 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.10: Comparing Narrators

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare how two narrators tell the same event.

Warm-Up

1. Point of view of both versions

2. Are both narrators characters?

Compare

3. How does each narrator feel about Mia pointing?

4. What does Mia tell that Leo doesn't? Why might Leo leave it out?

Chapter 6

5. Retell an event from Chapter 6 from a different character's point of view in 3–4 sentences.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.11 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.11: Comparing Two Informational Texts

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare the focus and structure of two informational texts on the same topic.

Warm-Up

1 What is focus?

2 Same topic of both texts

Compare

3 Why did keepers climb the tower several times a night? (Text A) How might the Fresnel lens have changed keepers' work? (Text B + your thinking)

4 What do you learn from reading both texts that you wouldn't learn from just one?

Exit Ticket

5 How do flash patterns help sailors?

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.12 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.12: Speaking Knowledgeably from Two Texts

Name _____ Date _____

I can present what I learned from two texts in a short talk.

Warm-Up

1 A hook is...

2 Speak at a ___ pace.

Plan Your Talk

3 Hook:

4 Facts from Text A:

5 Facts from Text B:

6 Conclusion:

Present

7 Give your 1–2 minute talk to your family. Ask a listener to write one thing you did well.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Mar 12 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 15: Comparing Texts

Name _____ Date _____

Read Text A

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Text A: The Owl

An original informational text

Owls are skilled night hunters. Their huge eyes gather light, and their soft feathers let them fly almost silently. An owl can hear a mouse moving under the snow.

Read Text B, then answer

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Text B: The Hawk

An original informational text

Hawks hunt during the day. Their sharp eyesight lets them spot a rabbit from high in the sky. Then they dive at speeds of more than 100 miles per hour.

1. When does each bird hunt?

2. Which sense does each text say helps the bird most?

3. Write one sentence comparing the birds using a comparison transition.

4. Write one sentence contrasting the birds using a contrast transition.

5 Which structure would put “Owls: when, senses; Hawks: when, senses”?

A block

B point-by-point

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.13 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.13: Comparison Essay Structure

Name _____ Date _____

I can choose a structure for a compare-and-contrast essay.

Warm-Up

1 Block = ___ then ___

2 Thesis goes in the...

Plan

3 Write a thesis comparing Eli (The Castaway) and Jim Hawkins (Chapters 5–7).

4 Which structure will you use? Why?

Exit Ticket

5 What happened to Jim in Chapter 7?

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.14 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.14: Planning the Comparison Essay

Name _____ Date _____

I can gather evidence and outline a comparison essay.

Warm-Up

1. Venn middle =

2. Outline first part

Gather Evidence

3. Eli only:

4. Both:

5. Jim only:

Outline

6. Intro/thesis:

7. Body 1 + evidence:

8 Body 2 + evidence:

9 Conclusion:

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.15 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.15: Drafting the Comparison Essay

Name _____ Date _____

I can draft a comparison essay with transitions and evidence.

Warm-Up

1. Similarly signals...

2. However signals...

Draft

3 Draft your comparison essay from your Lesson 5.14 outline.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.16 · PRACTICE

Lesson 5.16: Revising and Editing the Comparison Essay

Name _____ Date _____

I can revise and edit my comparison essay.

Warm-Up

1 Title format: Treasure Island (handwritten)

2 Title format: "The Castaway of Pelican Key"

Revise and Edit

3 Use the checklist. List two revisions and two edits you made.

4 Copy your revised thesis.

Exit Ticket

5 What did you learn about comparing texts this unit?

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Mar 25 (homework) or as needed · ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Unit 5 Review

Name _____ Date _____

Skills

1. Turning point of a plot

2. STEAL stands for

3. A title for a section

4. Letters/journal story

5. Structure: all A, then all B

6. Contrast transition

Apply

7. Compare Text A and Text B about lighthouses in two sentences.

8. Write a thesis comparing Ben Gunn and Eli.

UNIT TEST · Fri Mar 26 · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Unit 5 Test

Name _____ Date _____

Show your work. This test has 15 points.

Part A · Text A (1 point each)

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Text A: The Iditarod

An original informational text

1 Every March, mushers and their sled dogs race about 1,000 miles across Alaska in the Iditarod. The trail crosses frozen rivers, mountains, and lonely tundra.

2 The race honors a famous trip in 1925. A sickness called diphtheria broke out in the town of Nome, and the medicine needed to stop it was hundreds of miles away. With no roads and planes unable to fly in the cold, teams of sled dogs carried the medicine in a relay. They made the trip in about five and a half days.

3 Today, mushers spend more than a week on the trail. They care for their dogs first, feeding them and checking their paws at every stop.

1 How long is the Iditarod?

2 Why did the 1925 trip happen? Explain with two details.

3 What is the main idea of Text A?

Part B · Text B (1 point each)

HISTORICAL FICTION

Text B: Balto's Run · A Story

An original story based on a real event

1 The wind howled across the ice, so cold it stung like needles. Gunnar Kaasen could barely see his own hands. “Balto, take us home,” he whispered to the lead dog.

2 Balto pressed his nose to the snow. Even in the whiteout, he found the trail. When the sled almost slid onto thin ice, Balto stopped short and refused to go on, then led the team around the danger.

3 At dawn, the team pulled into Nome. Kaasen fell to his knees beside Balto, pulling ice from the dog's paws. “You saved them,” he said. “You saved them all.”

4 What kind of text is Text B?

A informational article
B historical fiction story
C a play

5 What does Balto do at the climax? What does it show about him?

6 Explain the simile “so cold it stung like needles.”

Part C · Compare (1 point each)

7 What is the focus of each text?

8 What do you learn from Text B that Text A doesn't tell?

9 What do you learn from Text A that Text B doesn't tell?

Part D · Write (5 points)

10 Write a comparison paragraph about Text A and Text B. Include a topic sentence naming both texts, evidence from each, comparison and contrast transitions, and a conclusion.

UNIT 6

Sources and Evidence

Primary and secondary sources, reasons and evidence, opinion writing, diagrams, maps, graphs, and a short research report, with Treasure Island Chapters 8–9.

Your practice pages for Unit 6. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

primary source	Created at the time by someone who was there.
secondary source	Written later to explain.
claim	The main opinion.
evidence	Facts that support a reason.
bibliography	A list of sources.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.1 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.1: Primary and Secondary Sources

Name _____ Date _____

I can tell the difference between primary and secondary sources and explain what each offers.

Warm-Up

1. Primary source example

2. Secondary source example

Sort the Sources

3. a photograph taken in 1900

4. an encyclopedia article on the Titanic

5. a letter from a soldier

6. a biography of Abraham Lincoln written in 2010

7. Grandma's diary from 1965

8. a website explaining volcanoes

Compare

9. What can you learn from the ship's log that the article doesn't tell?

10. What does the article tell that the log doesn't?

Exit Ticket

11 Is Jim's narration in Treasure Island like a primary source? Explain.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.2 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.2: Comparing Sources on the Same Topic

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare what two sources say about the same topic and notice agreements and differences.

Warm-Up

1 Corroborate means...

2 If sources disagree, look for...

Compare

3 What topic do both texts share?

4 How does each text help explain why the age of sail ended?

5 Write one fact the two texts corroborate.

Exit Ticket

6 Why is it smart to check more than one source?

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.3 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.3: Is This Source Reliable?

Name _____ Date _____

I can judge whether a source is reliable.

Warm-Up

1 Reliable means...

2 Credentials are...

Reliable or Not?

3 A 1965 encyclopedia article about space exploration

4 A National Park Service page about Yellowstone

5 A video by a toy company saying its toy is “the best ever”

6 A book on sharks by a marine biologist, published last year

Exit Ticket

7 Write two questions you'll ask about any website you use for research.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.4 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.4: Taking Notes from Sources

Name _____ Date _____

I can take notes in my own words and record where each fact came from.

Warm-Up

1. Notes should be in...

2. Each note needs a...

Take Notes

3. Take two notes from "From Sail to Steam." Include the source.

4. Take two notes from Source 2, "Life on Long Voyages."

Exit Ticket

5. Turn one note into a sentence in your own words.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Apr 2 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 16: Sources

Name _____ Date _____

Read Source A

PRIMARY SOURCE

Source A: Diary of Ruth, 1849 (invented for this check)

A primary source written for this check

We have been walking beside the wagons for three weeks. My shoes have holes, and the dust gets into everything, even the bread. Today we crossed a river, and our wagon nearly tipped. Mother held my hand so tightly it hurt.

Read Source B, then answer

SECONDARY SOURCE

Source B: The Oregon Trail

A secondary source (original informational text)

Between 1840 and 1860, hundreds of thousands of people traveled west on the Oregon Trail. The 2,000-mile journey took four to six months. Most travelers walked beside their wagons to keep the load light. River crossings were among the most dangerous parts of the trip.

1 Source A is a...

A primary source
B secondary source

2 How do you know?

3 Write one fact Source B gives that Source A doesn't.

4 What do both sources show about river crossings?

5 Take a note from Source B in your own words with the source.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.5 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.5: Claims, Reasons, and Evidence

Name _____ Date _____

I can identify an author's claim, reasons, and evidence.

Warm-Up

1 A claim is...

2 Evidence answers...

Analyze

OPINION WRITING

Should Fourth Graders Have Homework?

An original opinion piece

1 Many people argue about homework. I believe fourth graders should have a small amount of homework, about twenty minutes a night.

2 First, homework helps students practice. When students practice math facts or reading at home, they remember them better. A teacher at my school said her students' test scores rose after she assigned ten minutes of nightly reading.

3 Second, homework teaches responsibility. Students learn to plan their time and finish work without someone reminding them.

4 However, too much homework can be harmful. Children need time to play, rest, and be with their families. That is why twenty minutes is the right amount: enough to practice, but not so much that it takes over the evening.

3 List the author's two reasons.

4 Which reason is better supported? Why?

5 How does paragraph 4 make the argument stronger?

Exit Ticket

6 What evidence could the author add to support Reason 2?

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.6 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.6: Evaluating Evidence

Name _____ Date _____

I can decide whether evidence is relevant and strong enough to support a reason.

Warm-Up

1. Relevant means...

2. A warning word for exaggeration

Strong or Weak?

3. Claim: Bikes are good exercise. Evidence: Doctors say biking strengthens the heart.

4. Claim: Our town needs a library. Evidence: Libraries are cool.

5. Claim: Recycling helps. Evidence: Our town recycled 2 tons of paper last year, saving about 34 trees.

6. Claim: Cats are the best pets. Evidence: My cat is orange.

Exit Ticket

7. Rewrite this weak evidence to be stronger: “Reading is fun, so kids should read every day.”

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.7 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.7: Opinion Writing: Claims and Reasons

Name _____ Date _____

I can state an opinion and support it with reasons and evidence.

Warm-Up

1. An opinion piece starts with...

2. Each reason needs...

Plan Your Opinion Piece

3. Prompt: Was Jim Hawkins brave or reckless? Your opinion:

4. Reason 1 and evidence from the Reader:

5. Reason 2 and evidence:

Exit Ticket

6. Write a hook for your opinion piece.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.8 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.8: Opinion Writing: Linking Words and Conclusions

Name _____ Date _____

I can link my opinion and reasons with transitions and write a strong conclusion.

Warm-Up

1. Linking word that shows cause

2. Linking word for the strongest reason

Write

3 Write your opinion piece: Was Jim Hawkins brave or reckless? Use your plan from Lesson 6.7, linking words, and a conclusion.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Apr 9 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 17: Reasons and Evidence

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

OPINION WRITING

Our Town Needs a Dog Park

An original opinion piece

1 Our town should build a dog park. Dogs need exercise, and many families live in apartments without yards. A study in another city found that dog parks reduced the number of dogs running loose on the streets.

2 Dog parks also bring people together. Neighbors meet and talk while their dogs play. And dog parks are fun! Everyone loves dogs.

1. What is the author's claim?

2. List the two reasons.

3. Which piece of evidence is strongest? Why?

4. Which piece of evidence is weakest? Why?

5. Suggest one piece of stronger evidence for Reason 2.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.9 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.9: Reading Labeled Diagrams

Name _____ Date _____

I can use a labeled diagram to understand a text.

Warm-Up

1. A label is...

2. A diagram shows...

Use the Diagram

3. Explain how a schooner's sails were different from a square-rigged ship's sails. How does the diagram help?

4. Explain how a sailor would steer and adjust the ship, using three labels.

Exit Ticket

5. Which is more helpful for you: the text or the diagram? Why?

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.10 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.10: Reading Maps

Name _____ Date _____

I can use a map's key, compass rose, and scale to answer questions.

Warm-Up

1. What shows directions?

2. What explains symbols?

Use the Map

3. Where can ships anchor?

4. What lies near the center?

5. Direction from the hills to the swamp

6. Direction from the treasure to the stockade

Explain

7. How would this map help a treasure hunter? Use two map features.

Exit Ticket

8. Draw a small map of your room or yard with a key and compass rose.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.11 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.11: Reading Graphs in Informational Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain what a graph shows and how it supports the text.

Warm-Up

1. Read a graph's ___ first.

2. What does the y-axis show here?

Use the Graph

3. Percent in 1820

4. Percent in 1900

5. Increase from 1850 to 1900

6. Did sailing ships still carry some cargo in 1900?

Explain

7. Write two sentences explaining how the graph and the text work together.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.12 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.12: Adding Visuals to Your Writing

Name _____ Date _____

I can add a diagram, map, chart, or graph to my own informational writing.

Warm-Up

1. Visual for events over time

2. Visual for amounts

Create

3. Choose a topic you know well. Create a visual for it with a title, labels, and a caption.

4. Write three sentences about the topic that refer to your visual.

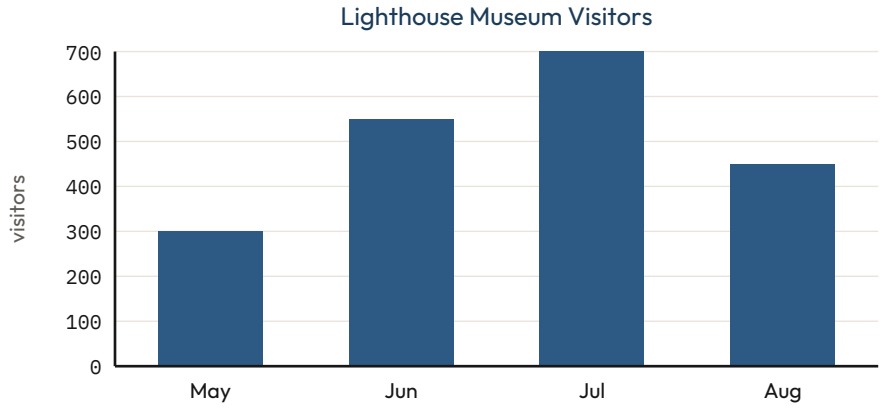
WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Apr 16 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 18: Visual Information

Name _____ Date _____

Use the graph and answer

1 Which month had the most visitors?



2 About how many visitors in June?

3 How many more in July than in May?

4 What pattern does the graph show?

5 Write a caption for the graph.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.13 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.13: Starting a Research Project

Name _____ Date _____

I can choose a research question and find sources to answer it.

Warm-Up

1 A research question should be...

2 Can it be answered with yes or no?

Plan

3 Write your research question about ships, the sea, or life in the 1700s.

4 List two or three sources you could use (texts in this book, the Reader, library books, reliable websites). Use the Lesson 6.3 questions.

Exit Ticket

5 Why is your question focused enough?

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.14 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.14: Organizing Research Notes

Name _____ Date _____

I can sort my notes into categories that will become paragraphs.

Warm-Up

1. A category is...

2. Each category becomes...

Organize

3. Write at least six notes for your research question (with sources).

4. Sort them into two or three categories with headings.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.15 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.15: Drafting a Research Report

Name _____ Date _____

I can draft a short research report from my notes and list my sources.

Warm-Up

1. A bibliography is...

2. A report's facts should be in...

Draft

3 Draft your research report.

4 Source list:

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.16 · PRACTICE

Lesson 6.16: Revising and Presenting Research

Name _____ Date _____

I can revise my report and present it to an audience.

Warm-Up

1. Conclusion answers the...

2. Present with a...

Revise and Present

3. List two revisions you made.

4. Present your report. Ask your audience one question afterward. What did they ask you?

Exit Ticket

5. What was the most interesting thing you learned in your research?

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Apr 22 (homework) or as needed · ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Unit 6 Review

Name _____ Date _____

Skills

1. Primary or secondary: a letter from 1850

2. A claim is...

3. Evidence answers...

4. What does a map key do?

5. Visual for parts of something

6. A bibliography is...

Apply

7. Is this strong evidence? “Our class should get a fish tank because fish are pretty.” Explain and improve it.

8. Write a focused research question about bees.

UNIT TEST · Fri Apr 23 · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Unit 6 Test

Name _____ Date _____

Show your work. This test has 14 points.

Part A · Information and features (1 point each)

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Why Bees Matter

An original informational text

Tiny Workers, Big Job

Bees are much more than insects that buzz and sting. As they collect nectar, bees carry pollen from flower to flower. This process, called pollination, helps plants make fruits and seeds.

Food on Our Tables

Scientists estimate that about one out of every three bites of food we eat depends on pollinators such as bees. Apples, almonds, blueberries, and cucumbers all need pollination.

Bees in Trouble

In recent years, the number of honeybee colonies in some areas has dropped. Scientists point to several causes, including the loss of wildflowers, harmful chemicals, and diseases.

How You Can Help

People can help by planting flowers, avoiding chemicals that harm bees, and leaving some wild areas in their yards. Even a single pot of flowers on a balcony can feed bees.

1 What is pollination?

2 Under which heading would you find ways to help bees?

3 What evidence shows bees matter to people's food?

4 List two causes of the drop in honeybee colonies.

5 This text is a...

A primary source

B secondary source

Part B · Reasons and evidence (1 point each)

6 The author claims people can help bees. What evidence or examples support this?

7 What visual could the author add, and why?

8 Write one note from the text in your own words with the source.

Part C · Opinion writing (6 points)

9 Should every family plant flowers for bees? Write an opinion paragraph with a clear opinion, two reasons with evidence from the text, linking words, and a conclusion.

UNIT 7

Reading Across Texts

Text sets, quests across cultures, myth and science explanations, integrating sources, discussion, and the synthesis essay, with King Arthur Chapters 13–16.

Your practice pages for Unit 7. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

text set	Texts about one topic.
quest	A journey toward an important goal.
myth	A traditional story explaining the world.
citation	Naming a source.
synthesis	Combining ideas from several texts.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.1 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.1: Reading a Text Set with a Guiding Question

Name _____ Date _____

I can read several texts on one topic with a guiding question in mind.

Warm-Up

1. A guiding question is...

2. Name one hero from this year's reading.

Build the Text Set

3. Guiding question: What makes a hero? Write what each of these adds: Arthur, Pip (Hollow Hill), Nell (Lighthouse), Ada (Bridge at Millbrook).

4. Chapter 13: What does Sir Percival add?

Exit Ticket

5. Write your first answer to the guiding question in one sentence.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.2 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.2: Annotating Across Texts

Name _____ Date _____

I can annotate texts to connect ideas across them.

Warm-Up

1. Code for new information

2. Code for a great quote

Annotate Jason

MYTH

Jason and the Golden Fleece · A Greek Myth Retold

An original retelling of a traditional Greek myth

1 Long ago in Greece, a young man named Jason learned that his uncle had stolen his father's throne. When Jason demanded it back, his uncle smiled slyly. “Bring me the Golden Fleece,” he said, “and the throne is yours.” The fleece hung in a faraway land, guarded by a dragon that never slept.

2 Jason built a great ship called the Argo and gathered the bravest heroes of Greece to sail with him. On the journey, they rowed past clashing rocks that smashed ships to splinters and faced storms and strange creatures.

3 In the land of the fleece, the king gave Jason impossible tasks, such as plowing a field with fire-breathing bulls. With the help of the king's daughter, Medea, who knew magic, Jason completed the tasks, put the dragon to sleep, and took the fleece.

4 Jason sailed home a hero. His quest had tested his courage, but he could not have succeeded alone.

3. Annotate “Jason and the Golden Fleece” with the codes. List two S connections and one D.

4 What dangers does Jason face on his quest?

5 Who helps Jason? Why does it matter?

Exit Ticket

6 Copy your best Q quote and explain why you chose it.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.3 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.3: The Quest Pattern Across Cultures

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare the quest pattern in stories from different cultures.

Warm-Up

1. What is a quest?

2. Name a type of traditional literature.

Compare the Quests

FOLKTALE

Momotaro, the Peach Boy · A Japanese Folktale Retold

An original retelling of a traditional Japanese folktale

1 An old woman washing clothes in a river saw a giant peach floating by. She carried it home, and when she and her husband cut it open, out stepped a baby boy. They named him Momotaro, which means “Peach Boy,” and raised him with love.

2 When Momotaro grew up, ogres were stealing from the villages nearby. Momotaro decided to stop them. His mother packed him millet dumplings for the journey.

3 Along the way, he shared his dumplings with a hungry dog, a monkey, and a pheasant. Each one joined him. Together they crossed the sea to the ogres' island. The pheasant flew over the walls, the monkey opened the gate, and the dog and Momotaro charged in. The ogres surrendered and returned everything they had stolen.

4 Momotaro came home with the treasure and his loyal friends, and the villages were safe again.

3. How are Jason's and Momotaro's quests alike? Give two similarities with evidence.

4 How are they different?

5 How does the Grail quest in the Reader fit this pattern?

Exit Ticket

6 What theme do both quest stories share?

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.4 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.4: Good and Evil in Traditional Stories

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare how traditional stories show good and evil.

Warm-Up

1. Opposition means...

2. A quality of a hero

Compare

3. Choose two stories. Explain how each shows good and evil, and what each culture valued.

Exit Ticket

4. Is every story this clear about good and evil? Give an example from King Arthur where it's complicated.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Apr 30 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 19: Quest Patterns

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

FOLKTALE

The Girl Who Brought Back the Spring · An Original Folktale

An original folktale

1 In a valley where winter never ended, a girl named Anya set out to find the Spring, which the Frost King had locked in his ice palace.

2 On the way, she shared her bread with a starving fox, freed a sparrow from a trap, and carried an old woman across a frozen river. Each one promised to help her.

3 At the palace, the fox showed her a secret tunnel, the sparrow pecked the key from the Frost King's belt, and the old woman, who was really the Spring Fairy, melted the ice with a touch. Anya returned home as flowers burst from the snow.

1. What is Anya's quest?

2. How does Anya gain helpers? What does this show about her?

3. Compare Anya's quest with Momotaro's. Give one similarity and one difference.

4 What theme does this folktale share with Momotaro?

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.5 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.5: Myths as Explanations

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how a myth explains something in nature.

Warm-Up

1 A myth explains...

2 Who is Demeter?

Use the Myth

MYTH

Persephone and the Seasons · A Greek Myth Retold

An original retelling of a traditional Greek myth

1 Demeter was the goddess of the harvest. Wherever she walked, crops grew tall and flowers bloomed. She loved nothing more than her daughter, Persephone.

2 One day Hades, ruler of the underworld, carried Persephone away to his dark kingdom. Demeter searched everywhere. In her grief, she stopped caring for the earth. Plants withered, snow fell, and people grew hungry.

3 At last, the king of the gods made an agreement. Persephone could return to her mother, but because she had eaten six pomegranate seeds in the underworld, she must spend six months of every year there.

4 And so, the ancient Greeks said, every year when Persephone goes below, Demeter mourns, and the earth grows cold and bare: autumn and winter. When Persephone returns, Demeter rejoices, and the earth blooms again: spring and summer.

3 Explain how the myth connects Demeter's feelings to the seasons.

4 What lesson about feelings might the myth teach?

Exit Ticket

5 Invent a one-sentence myth explaining why it rains.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.6 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.6: Scientific Explanations

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain a scientific process using details from the text.

Warm-Up

1 An axis is...

2 Two hemispheres

Explain

SCIENCE TEXT

What Causes the Seasons?

An original informational text

1 Many people think seasons happen because Earth moves closer to and farther from the sun. That's not the reason. In fact, Earth is closest to the sun in early January, during winter in the Northern Hemisphere.

2 The real cause is Earth's tilt. Earth's axis, the imaginary line it spins around, is tilted about 23.5 degrees. As Earth travels around the sun during the year, the tilt stays pointed the same direction in space.

3 For part of the year, the Northern Hemisphere is tilted toward the sun. Sunlight hits it more directly, and days are longer, so it is summer. Six months later, the Northern Hemisphere is tilted away from the sun. Sunlight hits at a low angle, days are shorter, and it is winter.

4 That's why, when it is summer in the United States, it is winter in Australia.

3 Explain the cause of seasons in three steps.

4 What evidence shows distance from the sun is NOT the cause?

Exit Ticket

5 Draw a quick sketch of Earth tilted toward the sun and label summer.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.7 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.7: Comparing a Myth and a Scientific Explanation

Name _____ Date _____

I can compare how a myth and a scientific text explain the same thing.

Warm-Up

1 Myth purpose

2 Science purpose

Compare

3 Write a paragraph comparing the two explanations of the seasons. Use a comparison transition and a contrast transition.

Exit Ticket

4 Answer the Get Ready question: Can a myth be valuable even if it isn't scientifically true? Explain.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.8 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.8: Which Explanation Is Better?

Name _____ Date _____

I can evaluate which of two explanations is clearer and better supported.

Warm-Up

1 Gravity is...

2 Is longer always better?

Evaluate

3 Explain why Explanation B is more complete. Use two details from B.

4 Is there anything Explanation A does well?

5 Add one sentence to Explanation A to make it better.

Exit Ticket

6 Which seasons explanation from this week was more complete, the myth or the science text, if your goal is to understand the cause? Why?

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri May 7 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 20: Comparing Explanations

Name _____ Date _____

Read Text A

MYTH

Text A: How the Moon Got Its Phases · An Original Myth

An original myth

Long ago, the Moon was proud of her round, silver face. Each month she grew so vain that she ate too many stars and swelled to a full circle. Then, ashamed, she hid her face a little more each night until she disappeared. Slowly she returned, and the cycle began again.

Read Text B, then answer

SCIENCE TEXT

Text B: Why the Moon Has Phases

An original science text

The moon does not make its own light. It reflects light from the sun. As the moon orbits Earth about once a month, we see different amounts of its sunlit side. When we see the whole lit side, it is a full moon. When the lit side faces away from us, it is a new moon.

1 According to the myth, why does the moon change shape?

2 According to science, why does the moon have phases?

3 Which text is based on evidence?

A Text A
B Text B

4 What lesson might the myth teach?

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.9 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.9: Integrating Details from Several Sources

Name _____ Date _____

I can combine details from several sources into one clear paragraph.

Warm-Up

1. Page age

2. Knight age

Integrate

3. Write a paragraph explaining what a squire did. Use details from at least two sources.

Chapter 15

4. Who achieves the Grail, and what qualities from the knight sources does he show?

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.10 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.10: Quoting and Citing Within Writing

Name _____ Date _____

I can include short quotations and name the source within my sentences.

Warm-Up

1. A citation tells...

2. Exact words need...

Practice

3. Write a sentence that cites "Becoming a Page" and includes a short quotation.

4. Write a sentence that cites "What Causes the Seasons?" and includes a short quotation.

5. Write a sentence that cites "Why the Ocean Has Tides" and includes a short quotation.

Exit Ticket

6. Why is citing sources important?

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.11 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.11: Quote, Paraphrase, or Summarize?

Name _____ Date _____

I can choose whether to quote, paraphrase, or summarize information from a source.

Warm-Up

1 Summarize =

2 Paraphrase =

Practice All Three

3 Quote from “Momotaro”:

4 Paraphrase one idea from “Momotaro”:

5 Summarize “Momotaro” in two sentences:

Exit Ticket

6 Which is hardest for you: quote, paraphrase, or summarize? Why?

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.12 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.12: Collaborative Discussion

Name _____ Date _____

I can take part in a discussion by building on others' ideas and using evidence.

Warm-Up

1. A discussion norm

2. Starter to add on

Prepare

3. Discussion question: Why did Galahad achieve the Grail when other great knights did not? Write your answer with two pieces of evidence from the Reader.

4. Write one question to ask others.

Reflect

5. After the discussion: What idea did someone else share that changed or added to your thinking?

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri May 14 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 21: Integrating Sources

Name _____ Date _____

Read Source A

SOURCE A

Source A: Castle Walls

An original informational text

Castle walls were often more than ten feet thick at the bottom. They were built from stone because wood could be burned by attackers.

Read Source B, then answer

SOURCE B

Source B: Under Attack

An original informational text

Attackers sometimes surrounded a castle for months, a tactic called a siege, hoping the people inside would run out of food. Castles stored grain and had wells so they could survive a long siege.

1. What is a siege?

2. Write one sentence that integrates a detail from each source.

3. Write a sentence that cites Source A with a short quotation.

4 To give the main points of Source B, you would...

A quote it

B summarize it

C copy it

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.13 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.13: Planning a Synthesis Essay

Name _____ Date _____

I can plan an essay that answers a guiding question with evidence from several texts.

Warm-Up

1. Synthesis combines...

2. Guiding question this unit

Plan

3. Your thesis:

4. Body 1 point + two texts with evidence:

5. Body 2 point + two texts with evidence:

6. Conclusion idea:

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.14 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.14: Drafting the Synthesis Essay

Name _____ Date _____

I can draft a synthesis essay that integrates and cites several texts.

Warm-Up

1. Transition: In the same ___

2. Short story title format

Draft

3 Draft your synthesis essay.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.15 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.15: Revising with Peer Feedback

Name _____ Date _____

I can give and use helpful feedback to revise my essay.

Warm-Up

1. Feedback should be...

2. Unhelpful feedback example

Give and Use Feedback

3. Feedback I received (two comments):

4. Two revisions I made because of it:

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.16 · PRACTICE

Lesson 7.16: Editing and Publishing the Synthesis Essay

Name _____ Date _____

I can edit and publish my synthesis essay.

Warm-Up

1. Comma after: Similarly

2. Typed book titles are...

Edit Sentences

3. in addition jason needed help

4. according to the seasons text earth is tilted

5. momotaro shared his dumplings

6. however the myth explains winter

Publish

7. Publish your essay. Write your final title here and one sentence about what you're proudest of.

UNIT REVIEW · Thu May 20 (homework) or as needed · ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Unit 7 Review

Name _____ Date _____

Skills

1. A text set is...

2. Steps of the quest pattern

3. Myths explain with...

4. Science explains with...

5. Citation starter

6. Feedback should be...

Apply

7. Integrate details from two knight sources into one sentence.

8. Write a thesis answering: What makes a good explanation?

UNIT TEST · Fri May 21 · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Unit 7 Test

Name _____ Date _____

Show your work. This test has 15 points.

Part A · Text A (1 point each)

MYTH

Text A: Vulcan's Forge · A Roman Myth Retold

An original retelling of a traditional Roman myth

1 The ancient Romans told of Vulcan, the god of fire and metalworking. Deep beneath a mountain, Vulcan kept his forge, where he hammered out armor and thunderbolts for the gods.

2 When Vulcan worked hard, smoke and sparks poured from the top of the mountain, and the ground shook with the pounding of his hammer. Sometimes, when he was angry, melted rock spilled down the mountainside.

3 Our word volcano comes from Vulcan's name.

1. What does the myth say causes smoke and sparks from the mountain?

2. What does the myth say causes melted rock to spill out?

3. What word comes from Vulcan's name?

Part B · Text B (1 point each)

SCIENCE TEXT

Text B: How Volcanoes Form

An original science text

1 Deep under Earth's surface, it is so hot that some rock melts into a thick liquid called magma. Magma is lighter than the solid rock around it, so it slowly rises.

2 When magma collects under the surface, pressure builds, like the pressure in a shaken soda bottle. If the pressure becomes great enough, magma bursts out through an opening. Once it reaches the surface, it is called lava.

3 Eruptions can send out ash, gas, and rock. Before many eruptions, the ground shakes with small earthquakes as magma moves underground. Scientists watch for these signs to warn people living nearby.

4 What is the difference between magma and lava?

5 Explain the soda-bottle comparison.

6 Why do scientists watch for small earthquakes?

Part C · Compare and integrate (1 point each)

7 Both texts mention the ground shaking. How does each explain it?

8 Which text's main purpose is to inform with evidence?

A Text A
B Text B

9 What do the ancient Romans' myth and modern science both notice about volcanoes?

Part D · Synthesis writing (5 points)

10 Write a paragraph comparing how the two texts explain volcanoes. Include a topic sentence, evidence from both texts with citations, comparison and contrast transitions, and a concluding sentence about why both texts are valuable.

UNIT 8

Grammar and Conventions

Nouns, pronouns, verbs, complete sentences, capitalization, punctuation, confused words, and editing, with King Arthur Chapters 17–20.

Your practice pages for Unit 8. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

noun	A person, place, thing, or idea.
pronoun	A word that replaces a noun.
tense	When a verb's action happens.
fragment	An incomplete sentence.
run-on	Sentences joined without correct punctuation.
homophones	Words that sound alike but differ in meaning and spelling.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.1 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.1: Nouns: Common, Proper, and Plural

Name _____ Date _____

I can identify common and proper nouns and spell plural nouns correctly.

Warm-Up

1. A noun names...

2. Proper nouns begin with...

Write the Plural

3. castle

4. bench

5. berry

6. monkey

7. leaf

8. tooth

9. fox

10. child

11. princess

12. goose

Common or Proper?

13. river

14. Mississippi River

15. Saturday

16. knight

17. Lancelot

18. kingdom

Exit Ticket

19 Write a sentence about Chapter 17 with two proper nouns and one irregular plural.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.2 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.2: Possessive Nouns

Name _____ Date _____

I can use apostrophes to show possession.

Warm-Up

1 Possessive shows...

2 Plural of knight

Write the Possessive

3 the cloak of Merlin

4 the shields of the knights

5 the toys of the puppies

6 the boots of the men

7 the castle of the king

8 the tails of the mice

Plural or Possessive?

9 Three ___ rode into the forest.

A knight's
B knights
C knights'

10 The ___ armor was shiny.

A knights
B knight's
C knightes

11 All the ___ horses were tired.

A knights'
B knight's
C knights

Exit Ticket

12 Write a sentence with a singular possessive and a sentence with a plural possessive.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.3 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.3: Pronouns and Relative Pronouns

Name _____ Date _____

I can use pronouns, including relative pronouns, correctly.

Warm-Up

1. Pronoun for Merlin

2. Pronoun for the knights

Choose the Relative Pronoun

3. The knight ___ horse was white rode first.

4. The castle ___ stood on the hill was old.

5. Ada, ___ saw the cracked post, warned everyone.

6. This is the book ___ I love.

7. The girl ___ won the prize smiled.

8. Camelot, ___ was Arthur's home, was beautiful.

Replace with Pronouns

9. Rewrite with pronouns: “Arthur took Arthur's sword, and Arthur rode to meet Arthur's knights.”

Exit Ticket

10 Combine with a relative pronoun: Lancelot was a great knight. Lancelot came from France.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.4 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.4: Agreement: Subjects, Verbs, and Pronouns

Name _____ Date _____

I can make subjects and verbs agree and pronouns agree with the nouns they replace.

Warm-Up

1. The dog ___ (bark/barks).

2. The dogs ___ (bark/barks).

Choose the Verb

3. The flowers in the garden ___ (bloom/blooms).

4. My brother ___ (play/plays) chess.

5. Jim and Ben ___ (search/searches).

6. The team ___ (win/wins) often.

7. One of the maps ___ (is/are) torn.

8. The pirates ___ (was/were) angry.

Fix the Pronoun

9. The girls packed his bags.

10. Ellie lost their mitten.

11. The castle had their own well.

12. The boys said she were tired.

Exit Ticket

13 Write a sentence with two subjects joined by and and the correct verb.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri May 28 · ABOUT 15 MINUTES

Weekly Check 22: Nouns and Pronouns

Name _____ Date _____

Show what you know

1. Plural of half

2. Plural of mouse

3. Possessive: the hats of the ladies

4. Possessive: the bone of the dog

5. The knight ___ shield was dented fought on. (relative pronoun)

6. The castle, ___ was old, had a moat.

7. The boys and their dad ___ (go/goes) fishing.

8. Each of the girls ___ (has/have) a kite.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.5 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.5: Verb Tenses and Irregular Verbs

Name _____ Date _____

I can use past, present, and future tenses, including irregular verbs.

Warm-Up

1. Past of walk

2. Past of run

Write the Past Tense

3. throw

4. catch

5. speak

6. break

7. sing

8. think

9. begin

10. know

Fix the Tense

11. Last week we swimmed in the lake.

12. She has wrote three letters.

13. Tomorrow the knights rode to battle.

14. Jim seen the pirates.

Exit Ticket

15 Write two sentences about Chapter 18 in the past tense using two irregular verbs.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.6 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.6: Progressive Tenses

Name _____ Date _____

I can use progressive verb tenses to show ongoing action.

Warm-Up

1 Helping verb for past progressive (he)

2 Helping verbs for future progressive

Write the Progressive Form

3 Right now, the birds ___ (sing).

4 At 9:00 last night, I ___ (sleep).

5 Tomorrow at noon, we ___ (travel).

6 The pirates ___ (dig) when Jim arrived.

7 She ___ (practice) piano every day this week.

8 Next week, Pip ___ (work) at the library.

Exit Ticket

9 Write a sentence using the past progressive to show one action interrupted by another.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.7 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.7: Modal Auxiliaries

Name _____ Date _____

I can use modal verbs such as can, may, and must to show ability, permission, and necessity.

Warm-Up

1. Modal for ability

2. Modal for necessity

Choose the Modal

3. Birds ___ fly. (ability)

4. It ___ snow tomorrow. (possibility)

5. Students ___ raise their hands. (necessity)

6. You ___ drink more water. (advice)

7. ___ you please pass the salt? (polite request)

8. ___ I go outside? (permission)

Exit Ticket

9. Write three rules for a knight using must, should, and may.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.8 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.8: Complete Sentences, Fragments, and Run-Ons

Name _____ Date _____

I can write complete sentences and fix fragments and run-ons.

Warm-Up

1. A sentence needs a subject and a...

2. Run-on means...

Sentence, Fragment, or Run-On?

3. The knights.

4. Merlin waved his staff.

5. It was late we went home.

6. After the feast ended.

7. The horse galloped away it never came back.

8. Pip opened the door.

Fix It

9. Under the old bridge.

10. The wind howled the ship rocked.

11. Because she was brave.

12. We packed our bags we left at dawn.

Exit Ticket

13 Write a fragment, then fix it into a complete sentence.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Jun 4 · ABOUT 15 MINUTES

Weekly Check 23: Verbs and Sentences

Name _____ Date _____

Show what you know

1. Past of bring

2. Has ___ (fly)

3. Past progressive: We ___ (sail) when the storm hit.

4. Modal for permission: ___ I leave?

5. Fragment or sentence: “Before the sun rose.”

6. Fix: The bell rang we ran inside.

7. Future progressive of wait (I)

8. Modal for necessity

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.9 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.9: Capitalization

Name _____ Date _____

I can capitalize words correctly.

Warm-Up

1. Capitalize: i

2. Capitalize days?

Fix the Capitals

3. sir lancelot came from france.

4. my birthday is in october.

5. we read treasure island by robert louis stevenson.

6. the king spoke to merlin.

7. on thanksgiving we ate turkey.

8. dr. livesey and i sailed in the spring.

Exit Ticket

9. Write a sentence with a title before a name, a place, and a month.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.10 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.10: Punctuating Dialogue

Name _____ Date _____

I can use commas and quotation marks correctly in dialogue.

Warm-Up

1 Quotation marks go around...

2 End marks go ___ the closing quotation mark.

Punctuate the Dialogue

3 the queen said welcome to camelot

4 is anyone there whispered pip

5 watch out yelled the farmer

6 I will help said Ben Gunn if you bring cheese

7 mother asked did you finish your chores

Exit Ticket

8 Write a two-line conversation between two knights. Start a new line for each speaker.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.11 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.11: Commas in Compound Sentences and Lists

Name _____ Date _____

I can use commas before conjunctions in compound sentences and in lists.

Warm-Up

1. A FANBOYS conjunction

2. Commas in a list separate…

Combine with a Comma and Conjunction

3. It rained. The game went on.

4. Nell lit the lamp. The ship turned.

5. You can ride. You can walk.

6. The bees shivered. The hive stayed warm.

Add Commas

7. Arthur Kay and Merlin rode north.

8. However the treasure was gone.

9. We packed apples cheese and bread.

10. Yes I found the key.

Exit Ticket

11 Write a compound sentence with so and a sentence with a list.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.12 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.12: Order of Adjectives and Prepositional Phrases

Name _____ Date _____

I can order adjectives correctly and use prepositional phrases.

Warm-Up

1. A preposition

2. Size before color?

Order the Adjectives

3. a (gray, huge, stone) castle

4. three (brown, little) puppies

5. an (old, interesting, leather) book

6. a (round, shiny, silver) shield

Prepositional Phrases

7. Underline: Pip walked through the tunnel.

8. Underline: After dinner, we read by the fire.

9. Add a when-phrase: The ship sailed ___.

10. Add a where-phrase: Ben Gunn lived ___.

Exit Ticket

11 Write a sentence describing an object with three adjectives in the correct order and one prepositional phrase.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Jun 11 · ABOUT 15 MINUTES

Weekly Check 24: Capitals and Punctuation

Name _____ Date _____

Show what you know

1. Capitalize: we visited lake erie in may.

2. Punctuate: help shouted the squire

3. Combine: I was hungry. I ate lunch. (so)

4. Add commas: Bring a map a lamp and a rope.

5. Order: a (wooden, small, brown) boat

6. Find the prepositional phrase: The cat slept on the rug.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.13 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.13: Frequently Confused Words

Name _____ Date _____

I can correctly use frequently confused words.

Warm-Up

1. They're =

2. It's =

Choose the Word

3. Put the books over ___.

4. ___ coming with us?

5. The knights fed ___ horses.

6. I have ___ dollars.

7. The ship lost ___ anchor.

8. Is this ___ helmet?

9. She ___ the answer.

10. This shirt is too big ___.

Edit

11. Their going too the fair. Its going to be fun!

Exit Ticket

12. Write one sentence using there, their, and they're correctly.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.14 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.14: Spelling Patterns and Checking Spelling

Name _____ Date _____

I can use spelling patterns and reference tools to spell words correctly.

Warm-Up

1. Silent letter in knight

2. i before e except after...

Add the Ending

3. make + ing

4. plan + ed

5. cry + ed

6. hop + ing

7. bake + ed

8. study + es

9. shine + ing

10. drop + ed

Find and Fix the Misspelling

11. The night rode a horse.

12. She recieved a letter.

13. We were runing late.

14. He hopped we would come.

Exit Ticket

15. Write three words you often misspell and the correct spelling of each.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.15 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.15: Punctuation and Words for Effect

Name _____ Date _____

I can choose punctuation and precise words for effect.

Warm-Up

1 What is an ellipsis?

2 A dash can add...

Revise for Effect

3 "The knight was brave."

4 "The cave was dark."

5 "We won the game."

6 "The bridge fell."

Exit Ticket

7 Rewrite one sentence from your synthesis essay (Unit 7) for effect.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.16 · PRACTICE

Lesson 8.16: Editing a Whole Passage

Name _____ Date _____

I can edit a passage for capitalization, punctuation, grammar, and spelling.

Warm-Up

1 Proofread means...

2 First editing pass

Edit the Passage

EDITING PASSAGE

Edit Me: A Feast at Camelot

A passage with mistakes for editing practice

1 last saturday sir gawain and sir kay rode to camelot for a feast. the kings hall was filled with knights ladys and musicians.

2 “where is sir lancelot” asked the queen. nobody new. their was an empty seat at the round table.

3 Rewrite paragraph 2 of “Edit Me: A Feast at Camelot” correctly.

Edit Your Own Writing

4 Choose a piece you wrote this year. Edit it in four passes. List three mistakes you fixed.

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Jun 17 (homework) or as needed · ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Unit 8 Review

Name _____ Date _____

Grammar

1. Plural of knife

2. Possessive: the toys of the children

3. Past of swim

4. Relative pronoun for people

5. Fix: Their going to the fair.

6. Fix: Its a nice day.

Editing

7. Edit: on friday jim said i found the map

8. Edit: the pirates was angry they wanted there treasure

UNIT TEST · Fri Jun 18 · ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Unit 8 Test

Name _____ Date _____

Show your work. This test has 18 points.

Part A · Grammar (1 point each)

1. Plural of story

2. Plural of foot

3. Possessive: the swords of the knights

4. The girl ___ bike was red rode away.

5. The basket of apples ___ (is/are) full.

6. Past of catch

7. Past progressive: She ___ (read) when I called.

8. Modal for advice: You ___ wear a coat.

Part B · Sentences and words (1 point each)

9. Fix the run-on: The wind blew the sails filled.

10. Fix the fragment: Under the old oak tree.

11. Order: a (silk, blue, lovely) ribbon

12. Choose: ___ (Your/You're) late!

Part C · Edit the letter (6 points)

EDITING PASSAGE

Edit Me: A Letter from Camelot

A letter with mistakes for editing

1 dear sir percival,

2 the knights of the round table is planning a tournament on june 12. we hope you and you're squire will come. their will be prizes for the best rider the strongest archer and the bravest knight.

3 queen guinevere said “bring your finest horse.” we cant wait to see you

4 your friend, sir gareth

13 Rewrite the letter correctly. Fix capitals, punctuation, agreement, and confused words.

UNIT 9

Capstone

Year in review, a writing portfolio, a capstone piece, and a presentation, with King Arthur Chapters 21–22.

Your practice pages for Unit 9. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

portfolio	A collection showing growth.
reflection	Writing that looks back on learning.
capstone	A final project.
goal	Something you plan to achieve.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.1 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.1: Vocabulary Review

Name _____ Date _____

I can use word parts, context clues, and figurative language skills to understand words.

Warm-Up

1 Prefix meaning “again”

_____

2 Suffix meaning “without”

_____

Vocabulary in Context

REALISTIC FICTION

The Last Lantern

An original story

1 Every night for sixty years, Grandmother Rosa lit a lantern in her window. The village children believed it was magic. Some said it kept wolves away; others said it called home lost sailors.

2 When Rosa grew too weak to climb the stairs, her grandson Mateo found her staring at the dark window. “Who will light it now?” she whispered.

3 Mateo had always thought the lantern was silly. But that night, he climbed the stairs, struck a match, and lit the wick. The flame trembled, then glowed steady and gold.

4 The next morning, a fisherman knocked at the door. “Last night the fog was so thick I lost my way,” he said. “Then I saw your light. I steered toward it and found the harbor.”

5 Mateo looked at his grandmother. She smiled. “It was never magic,” she said. “It was just someone remembering to care.” From then on, Mateo lit the lantern every night.

3 In paragraph 1, the children “believed it was magic.” What does the word “believed” suggest?

A They knew for certain.
B They thought so without proof.
C They were told the truth.

4 What does “steered” mean in paragraph 4? What clue helps?

_____

_____

5 Write a word from the story with a prefix or suffix and explain its meaning.

6 Use a strategy to define one hard word from Chapter 21. Name the strategy.

Exit Ticket

7 Which vocabulary strategy will you use most next year? Why?

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.2 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.2: Comprehension Review: Literature

Name _____ Date _____

I can determine theme, describe characters, and make inferences in a story.

Warm-Up

1 Theme is...

2 STEAL stands for...

Answer with Evidence

REALISTIC FICTION

The Last Lantern

An original story

1 Every night for sixty years, Grandmother Rosa lit a lantern in her window. The village children believed it was magic. Some said it kept wolves away; others said it called home lost sailors.

2 When Rosa grew too weak to climb the stairs, her grandson Mateo found her staring at the dark window. “Who will light it now?” she whispered.

3 Mateo had always thought the lantern was silly. But that night, he climbed the stairs, struck a match, and lit the wick. The flame trembled, then glowed steady and gold.

4 The next morning, a fisherman knocked at the door. “Last night the fog was so thick I lost my way,” he said. “Then I saw your light. I steered toward it and found the harbor.”

5 Mateo looked at his grandmother. She smiled. “It was never magic,” she said. “It was just someone remembering to care.” From then on, Mateo lit the lantern every night.

3 Why does Mateo light the lantern even though he thinks it's silly? Make an inference.

4 What is the theme? Support it with two details.

5 Compare the theme with “The Lighthouse Keeper's Daughter” (Unit 2).

Chapter 21

6 How does Arthur's story end? What theme does the ending suggest?

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.3 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.3: Comprehension Review: Informational Text

Name _____ Date _____

I can find main ideas, explain text structures, and use text features and evidence.

Warm-Up

1. Text feature in this article _____

2. Cause-effect signal word _____

Answer with Evidence

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Coral Reefs: Cities Under the Sea

An original informational text

Tiny Builders

A coral reef may look like a colorful rock, but it is built by millions of tiny animals called coral polyps. Each polyp makes a hard shell of limestone around its soft body. Over thousands of years, these shells pile up to form reefs.

A Busy Neighborhood

Reefs cover less than one percent of the ocean floor, yet about one quarter of all ocean species live on or near them. Fish, sea turtles, octopuses, and sharks find food and shelter among the coral.

Reefs in Danger

When ocean water becomes too warm, corals push out the tiny algae that live inside them and give them color and food. The coral turns white, which is called coral bleaching. If the water stays warm too long, the coral can die.

Protecting Reefs

Scientists are growing young corals in underwater nurseries and replanting them on damaged reefs. Visitors can help by never touching or standing on coral and by using sunscreen that is safe for reefs.

3 Why are reefs called “cities under the sea”? Use evidence.

4 Explain the cause and effect of coral bleaching.

5 What can visitors do to help? Paraphrase.

Exit Ticket

6 What visual would help this article? Why?

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.4 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.4: Strategies for Reading Tests

Name _____ Date _____

I can use smart strategies to answer reading questions.

Warm-Up

1 First step

2 Eliminate means...

Practice

3 In “Coral Reefs,” what do coral polyps build their shells from?

A sand
B limestone
C algae
D wood

4 Which sentence best states the theme of “The Last Lantern”?

A Lanterns are magic.
B Small acts of caring can make a big difference.
C Fog is dangerous.
D Grandmothers are old.

5 Answer with ACE: How did Mateo's opinion of the lantern change?

Exit Ticket

6 Which test strategy will you use first next time?

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Jun 25 · ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Weekly Check 25: Reading Review

Name _____ Date _____

Read and answer

REALISTIC FICTION

The Promise Tree

An original story

1 When Lily's family moved to the city, her grandfather gave her an acorn. “Plant this,” he said, “and when it grows, remember that you can grow anywhere.”

2 The city apartment had no yard. Lily planted the acorn in a coffee can on the fire escape. For weeks, nothing happened. She almost threw it away.

3 Then one spring morning, a tiny green shoot poked through the soil. Lily laughed out loud. She sent her grandfather a photo with three words: I'm growing too.

1. What did Grandfather mean by “you can grow anywhere”?

2. How does Lily feel when nothing grows? Clue?

3. What is the theme? Use two details.

4. “I'm growing too” is...

A literal only
B a comparison between the tree and Lily
C a simile using like

5 Point of view?

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.5 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.5: Building a Writing Portfolio

Name _____ Date _____

I can select pieces that show my growth as a writer.

Warm-Up

1. A portfolio shows...

2. Types of writing this year

Select Pieces

3. Piece 1: title and why you chose it

4. Piece 2: title and why you chose it

5. Piece 3: title and why you chose it

Chapter 22

6. How does the King Arthur Reader end? How did you feel about the ending?

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.6 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.6: Writing a Reflection

Name _____ Date _____

I can write a reflection about how I've grown as a reader and writer.

Warm-Up

1. A reflection looks...

2. A reflection should include an...

Reflect

3. Write a reflection paragraph about how you grew as a reader.

4. Write a reflection paragraph about how you grew as a writer.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.7 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.7: Setting Goals

Name _____ Date _____

I can set reading and writing goals for next year.

Warm-Up

1 A goal is...

2 Vague or specific: "Read more."

My Goals

3 Reading goal and plan:

4 Writing goal and plan:

5 Portfolio table of contents (titles in order):

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.8 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.8: Planning a Capstone Piece

Name _____ Date _____

I can plan a new piece of writing that shows my best skills.

Warm-Up

1. Narrative organizer

2. Opinion parts

Plan

3. My capstone option and topic:

4. My plan (use the matching organizer):

PORTFOLIO REVIEW · Fri Jul 2 · ABOUT 15 MINUTES

Weekly Check 26: Portfolio and Goals

Name _____ Date _____

Show what you know

1. A portfolio shows...

2. A reflection includes...

3. Make specific: “Write more.”

4. Organizer for a narrative

5. Organizer for opinion

6. What is a capstone?

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.9 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.9: Drafting and Revising for Ideas and Organization

Name _____ Date _____

I can draft my capstone and revise it for clear ideas and organization.

Warm-Up

1. Revise is about...

2. Edit is about...

Draft

3 Draft your capstone piece.

Revise

4 Two revisions for ideas or organization:

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.10 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.10: Revising for Word Choice and Sentence Variety

Name _____ Date _____

I can revise for precise words and varied sentences.

Warm-Up

1. A tired word

2. A combining word

Practice

3. Combine: Pip found a key. The key was brass.

4. Combine: Jim hid. He heard Silver's plan.

5. Vary: The storm ended after midnight.

Revise Your Capstone

6. Copy two sentences before and after revising for word choice or variety.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.11 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.11: Editing with a Checklist

Name _____ Date _____

I can edit my capstone for conventions using a checklist.

Warm-Up

1. Fix: i

_____

2. Fix: there going

_____

Edit Your Capstone

3. List the mistakes you fixed in each pass.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.12 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.12: Publishing

Name _____ Date _____

I can publish a polished final copy of my capstone.

Warm-Up

1. Publish means...

2. Where does the final copy go?

Publish

3. Publish your capstone. Write its title and describe one design choice you made.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Jul 9 · ABOUT 15 MINUTES

Weekly Check 27: Revising and Editing

Name _____ Date _____

Show what you know

1. Combine: The dog barked. The dog was small.

2. Vary: We left after lunch.

3. Edit: jim and i found there map

4. Edit: whats in the chest asked ben

5. Precise word for went (slowly)

6. Edit: The pirates was hungry they ate

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.13 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.13: Planning a Presentation with Evidence

Name _____ Date _____

I can plan a presentation that uses evidence from texts.

Warm-Up

1. A hook grabs...

2. Evidence comes from...

Plan

3. Hook:

4. Main point 1 + evidence:

5. Main point 2 + evidence:

6. Conclusion:

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.14 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.14: Visuals and Speaking Skills

Name _____ Date _____

I can use a visual and speak clearly to an audience.

Warm-Up

1. Speak at a ___ pace.

2. Look at your...

Create

3. Sketch your visual here first.

4. Write your note cards (key words only):

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.15 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.15: Practicing and Listening

Name _____ Date _____

I can practice my presentation and listen to identify a speaker's reasons and evidence.

Warm-Up

1. Good listeners...

2. Feedback should be...

Practice

3. Feedback I received:

4. Change I'll make:

Listen

5. Listener notes for someone else's practice talk:

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.16 · PRACTICE

Lesson 9.16: Presentation Day and Celebration

Name _____ Date _____

I can present my learning and reflect on my year.

After Presenting

1. How did your presentation go? What would you do differently?

2. Write a short note to yourself to read on the first day of fifth grade.

YEAR-END REVIEW · Thu Jul 15 (homework) or as needed · ABOUT 50 MINUTES

Year-End Review

Name _____ Date _____

Vocabulary and grammar

1. misplace means...

2. Achilles' heel means...

3. Plural of wolf

4. Past of bring

5. Fix: its raining

6. Possessive: toys of the children

Reading

7. Name three text structures and their signal words.

8. Explain the difference between theme and main idea.

9. Explain the difference between primary and secondary sources.

Writing

10. List the parts of an ACE response and an opinion essay.

YEAR-END TEST · Fri Jul 16 · ABOUT 60 MINUTES

Grade 4 ELA Year-End Test

Name _____ Date _____

Show your work. This test has 24 points.

Part A · Literature (1 point each)

REALISTIC FICTION

The Clockmaker's Apprentice

An original story

1 Old Master Brenner was the finest clockmaker in the city. His shop was crowded with clocks of every size: tall clocks in wooden cases, tiny clocks set in silver lockets, and one enormous clock in the window with a painted moon that rose and set each night.

2 When eleven-year-old Hana became his apprentice, she was so eager that she worked too quickly. Gears slipped from her tweezers. Springs flew across the room. Once she even dropped a pocket watch into a bowl of soup.

3 “Patience,” Master Brenner said, gently fishing the watch from the soup. “A clock cannot be rushed. Neither can a clockmaker.”

4 Hana frowned. She wanted to build something wonderful, not sweep up springs. But she tried to slow down. She learned to breathe before she lifted a gear and to check each tiny screw twice.

5 One winter night, the great clock in the window stopped. The moon froze halfway across its painted sky. Master Brenner was sick in bed, and the city's New Year celebration would begin at midnight, when everyone gathered to watch the moon clock strike twelve.

6 Hana opened the clock's case. Inside were hundreds of gears. Her heart raced, but she remembered: Patience. Slowly, carefully, she found the problem, a single bent tooth on one small gear. She straightened it with her tweezers, held her breath, and gave the pendulum a gentle push.

7 Tick. Tock. The painted moon began to move.

8 At midnight, the great clock struck twelve as the crowd cheered. Master Brenner, wrapped in a blanket at his window, smiled. Hana was no longer just an apprentice. She was a clockmaker.

1. Describe the setting in paragraph 1. Use two details.

2. What problem does Hana have at the beginning? Give evidence.

3. What does Master Brenner mean by “A clock cannot be rushed. Neither can a clockmaker”?

4. What is the climax of the story?

5. How does Hana change? Use evidence from the beginning and the end.

6. State the theme.

7. “The moon froze halfway across its painted sky” means…

A the moon turned to ice
B the painted moon stopped moving
C it was cold outside

Part B · Informational text (1 point each)

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

How Clocks Changed the World

An original informational text

Before Clocks

For thousands of years, people told time by the sun. Sundials used a shadow to show the hour, but they did not work on cloudy days or at night. Water clocks and candles marked with lines helped, but none were very exact.

Gears and Pendulums

The first mechanical clocks appeared in Europe around 1300. They used gears and falling weights. In 1656, a Dutch scientist named Christiaan Huygens built a clock with a pendulum, a weight that swings back and forth at a steady rate. Pendulum clocks were far more accurate than earlier clocks.

Time for Everyone

Accurate clocks changed daily life. Factories could set work hours, and trains could run on schedules. In fact, train travel led many countries to create standard time zones in the 1880s so that schedules made sense from city to city.

8 List two problems with telling time before mechanical clocks.

9 What is a pendulum, and why did it matter?

10 Which structure does the section “Time for Everyone” mostly use?

A cause and effect
B compare and contrast
C problem and solution

11 What is the main idea of the whole text?

Part C · Connect the texts (1 point each)

12 What kind of clock does Hana fix? Use Text B to explain how it works.

13 Why might a whole city care so much about one clock (Text A)? Use Text B for support.

Part D · Language (1 point each)

14 enormous (paragraph 1) means...

15 Plural of watch

16 Edit: hana said im ready

17 Combine: Hana was careful. Hana was brave.

Part E · Writing (6 points)

18 Opinion: Is patience the most important quality for an apprentice? Write a paragraph with a clear opinion, two reasons with evidence from the texts, linking words, and a conclusion.

Grade 4 English Language Arts

Student Workbook · 2026–2027

A full year of Grade 4 reading, writing, and language. Lessons pair the Core Knowledge Readers with close reading, vocabulary, grammar, and writing instruction, so students learn to read carefully, think deeply, and write with purpose.

This Student Workbook holds the daily practice pages for every lesson, plus each Friday's Weekly Check, the unit reviews, and the unit tests, with room to show thinking and write complete answers.

INSIDE THIS YEAR

01 Word Power
02 Reading Closely
03 Reading Longer Texts
04 The Writer's Craft
05 Reading Deeply
06 Sources and Evidence
07 Reading Across Texts
08 Grammar and Conventions
09 Capstone

IN THIS BOOK

- Warm-ups, practice, and exit tickets for every lesson
- Weekly Checks every Friday
- Unit reviews and unit tests
- Space to show work and explain thinking

THE COMPLETE SET



Textbook



Workbook

You are holding this book



Teacher Edition

Each lesson has the same number in all three books, and every day of the year is mapped to its lesson in the VenvLearning planner.